TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 1 - Micro Lecture 2
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Team Development
Narrator	Paul Moses
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Content

A team development model will outline the stages of how a group goes through the journey of becoming a team and of becoming a good and effective team. By understanding such models, it can help you as a leader shorten that journey, so that you can get to a good effective team faster, also so that you can make sure that the team stays at that stage rather than going backwards at any point. So with that, let's get straight into looking at all of the models, starting with Tuckman.

The group development model by Tuckman, is perhaps the classic development model for teams. And its five stages forming, storming, norming, performing, and adjourning. Let's talk through each of them. You'll see from the chart that as time goes by, you go through the five stages, but on the Y axis you have energy and productivity, you want to get to the point where the team is particularly productive obviously for your project.

To start with, we have the forming stage, and that's where members of the group are first put together. And it's a hard one for members of the group. They don't really understand what their role is in performing stage, what are their duties to perform? The members of the team can't necessarily even get started on their job without a leader or a manager, because they don't know what they're doing, and they may well lack confidence in what it is they're supposed to do. At this point, a leader needs to encourage and motivate the team so that they can start to feel like they are coming together as a team.

But then they move to the next step, storming, and that is where productivity will drop dramatically. Forming can only take a matter of a few days perhaps, storming can take longer to come out of, and if done poorly you're never coming out at the storming stage whatsoever. Storming is a situation where the team members have come together and they've started to butt heads, conflict has started to arise. Normally that's because you have different team members with different ideas of what to do or how to do it, or they just want to use different work styles. People work in lots of different ways for all sorts of different reasons, but having different work styles can cause problems and conflict, and it can cause frustrated team members. To come out of this stage the leader is required to try and pull the team together to move past the conflict, to solve whatever those conflicts are. It should help the team members learn to respect each other and understand what their role is within the team.

Once they do understand what their role is within the team, they move to the norming stage. That's the point where the team members start to get to know one another better. It's where social chats might start to happen. They'll begin to be able to gel as a team because they have some shared interests or previous experiences perhaps. It's the leadership job to try and get them to that point as fast as possible. Hopefully storming is only a week or two, it could take a lot longer, but once you've started to get the team to become not friends with each other, but accepting of each other. That's the point where you're in that norming step.

Once they have gelled together as a team and gone through norming, they're then into the point you really want them to be at, performing. That's where the team is fully gelled together and performing well, so the energy and productivity is nice and high at that point. This is the point where all members of the team know what it is that they are doing and they can perform those tasks without too many problems. Certainly not problems which are generated internally from just the team dynamics. That doesn't mean that your work as leader has stopped. There's always going to be extra ways to try and get more development out of people to try and improve them and therefore improve your project outputs. That's what you should be concentrating on trying to develop the performance of the team to make it even better.

Performing is hopefully where you can get to quite fast and it's hopefully where you're going to stay at for the entirety of the project. Until you get to the end, and that's where you enter the adjourning phase. This is where the group is finished and they split. They are sent off to do their own different things, and that's particularly true in a matrix type of organisation. So at this point the leader of the team needs to be appreciative of the team members, they need to do that throughout I suppose, but it's at the end where everybody needs to fully be congratulated and have the right kind of praise assigned to them. They can take that forward with them into another team, possibly with you again on a new project. This stage is all about increasing the motivation of the members to move on and to do something new. It can for people in the team, particularly when it's been a team that's been long in the making, it can be almost a period of mourning that it's breaking up the band and they are no longer going to be part of this high performing team doing the project that they really enjoyed. But such is the life of projects, they do finish. If you have a project that never finishes that's not a good thing, so you have to get to that adjoining step.

And that's the five steps of Tuckman. A really important thing to remember though, is that this isn't a one time process. It's easy to slip back and start again. You might be in a performing stage and then you might start to have some internal conflict that happens and you go back to storming. Most likely you have something change, projects that happen for a long time you're always going to have people that come in and out of the team. You might have people that leave for a new job. Or will get pulled away to do something else internally, or you might just have a project plan where you have extra people that come into the team later. As soon as you introduce a new dynamic into the team, you're back to the forming step, you're back at step one. It is your job as leader to try and push through the Tuckman steps to get to performing as fast as possible. But anytime you make a change, you will go back to the start and you will have the conflict that makes storming happen.

Tuckman’s model is relatively simple, although sometimes simple is the best and easiest to understand, but it might not show the whole story and it's sometimes nice just to have a different model and a perspective on things. So here's another. Here's the Drexler-Sibbet model of team performance. This is split into two different groups and then there are steps within each groups which we'll talk about on the next slide. But you have the initial creating stages, which is all around the group coming together to become a single cohesive unit, and then after you have the sustaining stages, where they've become a team and they're adjusting and they are establishing high performance effectively. So you can probably see the parallels back to Tuckman.

Drexler-Sibbet perhaps pays more detailed attention to the early stages, which Tuckman sums up with just forming and storming. Step one of Drexler-Sibbet is orientation. So that's why am I here? This is where the group learns why they've been brought together, and they might wonder what it is that they're going to do within this team and how they're going to do it and this step is or just about bringing out those questions.

Next, we go into trust building, described as who are you? So the members of the group may not know everybody within the team and this is the point where they start to build trust and get to know the other people in the team. They should learn who their teammates are, what their backgrounds are, what their skills might be, and then they can take those bits of knowledge forward into how to plan for the future steps. They might not know the experience levels or few other members of the team. They might not even know their areas of expertise, or perhaps even their names if it's a fast moving organisation bringing in lots of new people. So the team needs to get to know each other and learn who it is that they're working with. You can't build trust unless you have a good relationship with the other people.

Next is goal clarification. What are we doing here? The goal clarification step is the group figuring out, with the help of their leader, what it is that they're going to do, and then they can start to define what the roles within the team is? Who is going to do what within the team? So that definition of roles might exist to a certain extent already within the organisation. If it's got a formal structure you might have a designer, a quality checker, a programmer, anything else. And at that point it's pretty obvious who's going to do the software programming, it's the programmer. But even then you can push down to the next level of detail as to who is actually going to perform each task, and at that point it may not be as formally easy to understand who is going to do what. But this is where you now that you've worked out where the skills of the team lie, it’s how you are going to utilise them. With the help of the team explaining to you, you're not making all of these choices purely by yourself. This is where conflict can happen, this is sort of like storming in a way from Tuckman. You'll naturally get some conflict as the team starts to figure out who is going to do what.

The last step of this creating stage within the Drexler-Sibbet model is commitment. How will we do it? This defines how the team is going to work together as a group. How they're actually going to perform these tasks. In the last step they worked out who might do them, but this step is all about how are we actually going to do them. Once they've worked this out, they're ready to start.

And then the sustaining stages. This is potentially a bit less detailed than Tuckman. First, you've got implementation, so all of the previous steps were working out who was doing what, what the skills were, how it's going to happen. This is then putting it into practise implementing it. Once it has been implemented, you're into high performance hopefully, and the team is performing. And then finally you get to renewal, which isn't quite the same as Tuckman adjourning. Renewal is how do we keep going? This model doesn't get to the end of the project. This model is a bit more like an iterative loop, so once you're in high performance you take a step back, you have agile would call it a retrospective if you remember, but you look at how things have gone, are you going to continue in the same manner or should we change and do something slightly different? And that's an important bit of leadership about looking back to try and keep improving to get the performance to be even higher.

The Drexler-Sibbet model was from the 1980s, and now we're moving ahead in time to the early 2000s. Richard Hackman suggested a team effectiveness model and it's the left hand side of this diagram that's perhaps the most important bit. He suggested how teams need to be effective and what the five different items are that need to be in place to allow them to be effective.

The first one is that it's a real team. And that means that there's the existence of specified tasks for the team to perform. There's clear terms of who's doing what, there's a distribution of roles. Everybody understands their rights and it's a stable team, which is something that the previous two models don't really talk about. I mentioned how you go back to the beginning if something changes and that's not being stable I suppose, but Hackman pulls out team stability and stable membership of your team as being an important part.

The next is a compelling direction. That's that the team has got clear goals, but that they're consequential goals as well. They want to try and finish the project, they believe in the mission of what the project is trying to achieve.

Next is an enabling structure. This is whether the team has been well organised. Does it have a management structure? Is there a chain of work that needs to be performed? Is there a Gantt chart effectively? Do they understand what has to happen, in what order or if it's Agile, have they got some kind of Kanban board. But have they got a way of tracking, monitoring and structuring the tasks that they're going to perform?

And then round the outside of those three things in the triangle is expert coaching, so this is the team having access to high quality training and mentoring effectively. And then supportive context as well is round the outside in the circle. The supportive context is; does the team have all the necessary resources? Does it have all the equipment it needs? Does it have the skills that it needs? Are the people within the team being rewarded and supported? If they're not, then it's unlikely that they're going to be effective.

Then those five things put together lead into the right hand side of the diagram, which is more similar to the previous models we've talked about. If the team has got all of those five things needed for being an effective team, then they're going to use their talents effectively. You'll get the right amount of effort, and therefore they're going to be effective.

On to 2005 now in a different model, it's more of a concept I would argue than a model. Lencioni developed a book called The Five Dysfunctions of a Team. He argued that all teams are dysfunctional and that understanding the type and level of dysfunction can help a leader to improve how the team is working together. The five dysfunctions that he proposes were:

The absence of trust. If team members are worried about looking vulnerable or silly in front of each other then they are not going to be trusting of each other, and if you're not trusting then ideas will not be exchanged openly, and that's bad for how the team can work together.

Fear of conflict. If the team is full of people who really want to preserve harmony at all costs and do not want to engage in any kind of conflict, then that's going to stifle any kind of productive conflict. Not all conflict is a bad argument, some of it can create new ideas and new ways of achieving a goal. That's a really useful part of a team. So if everybody in the team is fearful of having that conflict, you're not going to get those new ideas come to the top.

Lack of commitment. The lack of clarity or buy-in prevents team members from making decisions that they're going to stick to. If you've got people in the team who promise to deliver something next week and then they don't, they have reneged on their commitments, then you're not going to be able to have an effective team.

Number four was the avoidance of accountability. The need to avoid interpersonal discomfort preventing team members from holding one another accountable. If people are unhappy with the idea of holding each other to account, which links back to not having a fear of conflict, then they are not going to be able to push themselves forward as a team. They're not going to be going back to Tuckman in that performing space, they're going to need a lot more hand holding from a leader to make them accountable.

And the last one was inattention to results. Obviously people in a team who are not that interested in the outcome are being slapdash or not going to be performing very well. Lencioni would argue that it's the leader that needs to make sure that the pursuit of individual people goals and personal status is not top of the list, it is making sure that the results that the project needs happen, not what individual people think is needed to pursue their own career goals regardless of the project.

So Lencioni put these 5 dysfunctions into a pyramid, and suggests that the elimination of those dysfunctions should be carried out from the bottom up. So you have to get rid of the absence of trust before you can tackle the fear of conflict, etc. And he bases this upon all different possible issues, conflicts and 'intrigues' as he calls them that might happen within your project. So any team dynamics can cause these things to happen. And much in the same way that you go back to the start at Tuckman when something changes, Lencioni would argue that your pyramid falls down and you have to start again, building up trust as soon as anything changes your team dynamic.

Moving on to the most recently published model, but you're going to see a lot of parallels with the previous models if I'm honest. The rocket model is a framework which has been developed to try and boost team performance, and it was created in response to various actual managers within organisations coming together with a company that formed the rocket model.

So the first step of it is actually not in the rocket. It's the context step, which is the blue circle or moon behind rocket. The context is looking at what are the critical assumptions. Team formation gets off to the best start when team members can share a common view of the context. Also often it turns out that team members are all operating on different assumptions and that fundamental disconnect leads to well intended but misaligned actions, and that hurts team morale and it reduces effectiveness.

The first part of the actual rocket itself is the mission, so why are we here? The team members agree on what success looks like. They set the stage for the effectiveness by doing that. What is it going to mean to successfully deliver this project? What are the goals? When do they need to be accomplished by? What are the strategies that team is going to use to make those goals happen? And how will they measure progress? By answering all of those questions they get clarity in what their goals are and clarity strengthens their mission.

Third one is talent. Do we have the talent that we need? It feels like it should be really easy to get the right number of people with the right talents within the team, and it often isn't. It's actually one of the toughest aspects of the resource side of project management, but it's also quite a tough aspect when it comes to building a team and that's because most organisations will assign people, staff members, to your team based on more than just availability. There is all going to be various things at play in who gets assigned to a team. There will be some politics, there will be some career development, some talent management and availability, and other projects that are happening that may or may not be more important than your project. So you as the team leader, you might believe that the skills and experience and abilities of the individual team members are all that matters, but there's going to be other considerations in how to bring the right sorts of people into your team compared to the rest of the organisation.

Next are the norms. What are the rules? So it's human nature for any group to develop norms for saying hello, how to sit down, communicating, how to decide what to do next. These unwritten rules usually turn into rules in people heads very fast without any kind of formal discussion. However, the teams that take time to actually talk through what those rules are, rather than just letting them organically happen and then get solidified in their heads, but the ones that talk it through and consciously decide what the norms are going to be really bring themselves together as a team.
So for instance, that is meetings maybe. Rather than having meetings and after the first five you've kind of settled into how meetings are going to work, and that's just happened organically. It's better to have an initial discussion about how meetings are going to form. Are you going to have agendas? Are people going to sit down or stand up? etc. But deciding that up front and talking about it is much better than letting it just naturally occur and get stuck as the way that people work.

Next is buy-in. Is everybody committed to success? Getting good buy-in happens when team members have a sort of 'team first' and not a 'me first' attitude. High performance teams are committed to delivering their goals and performing their role within the team to get to those goals, that's what's motivating for them. They understand how their work contributes to the greater good, and that links straight back to the previous one that we looked at in Hackman in terms of everybody having a clear mission and wanting to perform and succeed against it.

Next is resources. Do we have the resources needed? It's very normal for project management terminology to say 'resources' and mean 'people on the team', but that's not what the rocket model here means. This is talking around other types of resources, so there are tangible resources which we need to make sure our team has; is there a realistic budget, do we have the office space to sit in, computers, test equipment, the right kinds of software, technical support. Again, it goes back to having the right environment which Hackman put forward. But the rocket model also has intangibles, are there's some intangible resources needed? That is things like political support, having a project sponsor or steering group who are supportive of the project.

Number seven is morale. So it's how the team work through disagreements. The best teams are going to understand that managing conflict is not the same as avoiding or minimising conflict. Team members cultivate the necessary courage, almost, to raise difficult issues. And when they are happy enough doing that, going back to that sense of trust and feeling safe that previous models have talked about, that's where they can work through those arguments and those disagreements. We know that if there's not enough conflict within a team, it often means that problems are just being swept under the rug, they're going to exist. And that leads to an artificial harmony, and ultimately it can lead to something called groupthink, where nobody is willing to put forward a different idea. Too much conflict, however of course, is bad as well. That leads to chaos effectively, and backstabbing team members which you want to avoid.

Eight is results and it's the last one. This is are we achieving our goals? So high performing teams are meant to keep their eyes on the prize, they're supposed to keep looking at the end of the project. They measure the results against the project goals and they regularly track their progress based upon the previous steps where they looked at what they were going to be tracking. They learn from their successes and failures by looking backwards and taking lessons learned or holding retrospectives. It's understanding what the results are along the way. It's not like Tuckman's final adjourning, where it's just the end of a project and the teams disappearing, this is much more an iterative loop again, looking back trying to understand where the results are going and how you can impact them moving forwards.

I've given you quite a lot of models to think about here, and I promise that not all of my lectures on this module will be as long as this one. If you only remember one model then make it the classic Tuckman, but remember that's only internal to the team. Hackman is therefore useful too because that's about what the team needs around them, which is your responsibility as a leader to make happen. Lencioni is useful too for what the negatives are and to try and get on top of those negatives before they become a problem. All of the models are useful really, you need to be applying multiple models to your team because it's a complicated subject teams and leadership, but that's why it's part of your Masters degree.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 1 - Micro Lecture 3
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Leadership Styles
Narrator	Paul Moses
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Content

Leadership is something that you recognise when you see it and you notice it when it's not there for definite, but a lot of people will really struggle to articulate what leadership really is. You've likely had some experience of leadership, either from having to do it yourself through a job role, or because you've come into contact with good or bad leaders with previous experiences. Let's have a look and unpack some of the different styles of leadership and models of leadership.

There's always been considerable debate about the relationship between leadership and management, and for many years academics and business practitioners have always concluded that management and leadership are two different functions that require different skills and therefore different people. That's a rather old school view on it now, that old school view is that you start your career as a manager and then you develop yourself as a leader. Whilst being a manager you will have a focus on getting tasks done following the rules and telling your team what to do. Whereas leaders will be concerned about leading towards the future, rather than the here and the now, leaders will want followers rather than subordinates.

Arguing against this view though would be a management consultant academic called Peter Drucker. He would argue that effective managers need to strive to be both formal and informal leaders within their organisations, and that viewpoint has been supported by a lot of different research. The British Royal Navy for example, they supported a piece of research that was in line with Drucker, where they determined that the effective performers in their study tended to be both good leaders and good managers. Within a complex and volatile business environment, you need to be able to do both. The study also concluded that motivation was the most significant predictor of performance, both for project teams and for managers and for leaders.

The idea that a manager will just tell you what to do is a bit anachronistic. We all need to understand how to motivate and encourage other people, and that's leadership. The difference of the emphasis between management and leadership is that leadership competencies are going to be more intense and emotional. As a leader we need to learn to tap into the full spectrum of all the human drivers and motivations. So arguably that's the only real difference, it's the focus of the person carrying out the work rather than what the task actually is. Focus more on people and you'll demonstrate leadership, focus more on tasks and results and you'll be performing management.

An interesting note here is that if management aim is to promote stability, order, consistency, it's sort of easier than leadership, and it's ideally suited for an algorithm. Maybe in the future we won't really have managers or project managers because they will be done by computers. Amazon is already automating some of the management of its employees. But I think it's fair to say that it would be very hard for an algorithm to perform any leadership type of role.

An old and classic model of leadership would be Lewin, who has three different leadership styles. Lewin would say that leadership is either participative, authoritarian or delegative.

Participative managers, or leaders rather, would participate within the group. They'd offer guidance, but it would be democratic. They'd be listening to the other peoples arguments and ideas, and they'd come together to form an opinion. An authoritarian leader would just provide clear expectations and tell people what to do. That is very close to the management versus leadership that we were just talking about. And lastly, the delegative leader would be one that kind of sits back. They would offer very little guidance to the team, they would let them get on with it. That's not necessarily bad, it's not to say that they're taking no part whatsoever, but they're pushing a lot of responsibility onto the team. When you first look at this model, it feels quite clear that a participative leader is going to be the best, but it will depend on the situation and the organisation.

Another model, this time with six styles, is Goleman. Goleman does express some preferences as to what he believes are good and bad styles of leadership. The first would be commanding, which is very similar to Lewins authoritarian view. This is a commander, they're telling you what to do, and Goldman would say that that is not good. Next up you would have what Goldman thinks is the best kind of leader, and that's a visionary. That's somebody that sets out what the vision is going to be and tries to pull people along with them, to come on that vision on that journey. The next would be affiliative, that's somebody that puts the people in the team first, they care far more about the people side than the task side. Goleman would then say that Democratic is the next. Obviously a democrat, somebody that asks what do you think, they put it out to the team, they come back, collect the ideas and then they move forward. Goleman would have another one, which is pace setting, which would be bad according to him. That's somebody that sets the tone and the pace for the project. So it is still telling people what to do, but it's demonstrating it as well, so it's 'do what I'm doing at the moment'. A commander just tells you and gives you an order, a pacesetter still gives you that order, but they're doing it as well, and that's perhaps better than having somebody that is purely giving out commands and not doing anything for themselves. And the last one from Goleman is coaching. Somebody that tries to guide the team into how to do something. It's not that different necessarily from having a pacesetter or a commander ultimately, but it's a much more gentle way of trying to bring people to where you want them to be.

Now we get into some slightly more complicated models, and this is the Blake Mouton managerial grid that I asked you to do earlier in the lesson, just before this micro lecture. So within here there are four main categories and there's one in the middle, which is kind of middle of the road of all of them. Blake Mouton looks at two axes, it looks at:
The task concern, how important are tasks to the manager or the leader?
And people concern, how important are people?

If there is a leader or manager within this grid who has a low concern for tasks and people, then that is not a good place to be, they are an impoverished manager as the grid would describe them, they may have little care for either. If you have somebody that is far more concerned with the tasks than the people, then that is an authority obedience manager within this model. That is like Lewin somebody who is more authoritarian or within Goleman somebody that is more commanding. They care about the tasks they'll just talk about that, it doesn't really matter who is doing them, how that person is feeling, just get the tasks done. The opposite of that would be the Country Club manager, somebody that cares far more about the people and not very much about the tasks. How are you feeling today? If I give you this task, how will it make you feel? Are you going to be OK if I ask you to do this task? Things like that. It looks after the people very well, but it can lead to problems in actually getting stuff done and it can lead to having favourites within the team and that can lead to further conflict. And lastly, the ultimate where you really want to be, is somebody that's concerned with tasks and people in both the same high amount. That's not necessarily realistic, I don't know how many people are out there that really have equal concern for both, but that is what the grid would describe as a team manager, and that's the best place to be. And then in reality people will be middle of the road. They won't have ultimately no concern for tasks or people, but they will have a preference.

Before this micro lecture, in the lesson I mentioned there was no wrong answer for your Blake Moulton model leadership style, and that's true. But in reality, the context in which you are leading is going to make a difference. Leadership is situational, and in some situations there would absolutely be a wrong type of leadership to apply. The Hershey-Blanchard model is a situational model and it suggests no single leadership style is better than another, but instead you have to focus on the workplace factors and the team factors to choose the best way forward. You have to adjust your style to suit those that you're leading. So under this model successful leadership is both task relevant and relationship relevant. It's kind of middle of the road back on that last model we were looking at. To understand the Hersey-Blanchard model, that means that managers who are using it have to choose the leadership style as it relates to the maturity of their followers or the people who are in their team. For example, if follower maturity is high, then the model would suggest that the leader needs to provide very minimal guidance. By contrast, if the follower maturity is really low, then the manager might need to provide really explicit directions and supervise work quite closely to ensure that the team have understood what it is that they need to do and what's expected.

The maturity level of followers is at the bottom of that diagram, and it's divided into 3 categories. High, moderate and low. Higher maturity teams would be highly capable and confident individuals who are experienced and able to go and work on their own. Moderate maturity would be one of two things, it would be employees who are very capable but lack the confidence to take on responsibility, or it might be that they have confidence but they're not willing to do the task at hand. And finally, the low maturity employees aren't really skilled enough to do the task that's being asked them, although they might be very enthusiastic.

Hershey and Blanchard developed four types of leadership styles based upon those tasks and relationships. So they have a delegating style, a low task low relationship style where the leader allows the group to take responsibility for task decisions. And that's best used with the high maturity followers. A participating style, so a low task, high relationship style that emphasises shared ideas and decisions. That can be used with moderate level followers who are experienced but might lack the confidence to do the tasks assigned. Next is a selling style, so that's a high task, high relationship style in which the leader attempts to sell their ideas to the group by explaining the task directions in a persuasive way. That too is to be used with moderate followers, but unlike the previous participating style the followers here would have the ability, but are unwilling to do the job so it has to be sold to them. And lastly, a telling style, this is a high task, low relationship type style. Commanding, if we go back to one of the earlier models. And that's where the leadership gives explicit directions and supervisors will work closely, and that style is really geared towards the low maturity followers.

This concept is sort of similar to the management versus leadership debate that I started the micro lecture with, but it's brought more up to date with some more recent literature. The idea is that if everything is now leadership, then it could be broken into two different types of leadership. Transformational and transactional.

Dowton was the first to coin the term transformational leadership, but Burns and Bass have furthered it since during the 90s. A transformational leader is someone with charisma. They are inspiring, they stimulate followers intellectually, and they consider the individual. Whereas transactional leadership is about increasing compliance, reducing resistance, rewarding contributions and supporting mutual dependence.

Both styles are not exclusive, you can be both, but they are different approaches. Research from Bass has shown that transformational leadership is more effective and is more likely to increase the entrepreneurial behaviour of employees. One example of a transformational leader might be Richard Branson the co-founder of the Virgin Group. Branson stated that "nobody is successful alone and you cannot be a great leader without great people to lead. The trick is in striking the right balance between empowering your staff and being able to be an example that they can follow".

Transformational leadership in other literature has been broken down into these four points.
Idealised influence, so walking the talk
Inspirational motivation like I've just sort of discussed.
Individualised consideration, so really being people driven and caring about the followers and
intellectual stimulation, so being innovative and challenging the people below you to be innovative

as well.

There is some debate about whether or not transformational leadership is a personality trait, it's something that people are born with. Or if it's a behaviour trait, which means that somebody could be trained to become a transformational leader.

Just to end the micro lecture on a little bit of a history lesson to give you a footing on how leadership theory has evolved over time. Between the 20s to the 70s approximately, there were sort of two branches of leadership theory. One was behavioural looking at the behaviours of leaders but not thinking about the teams beneath them or ever changing or adapting the behaviours and the other was focusing more on the traits of leaders. So the characteristics and what makes a good leader? But again, not looking at different situations.

From the 70s onwards, contingency theories started to emerge and become much more popular and those are situational. That was all about how leaders should start adapting their behaviours depending on their situation. From the 90s onwards, with the transformational leadership that we've just seen, EI emotional intelligence theories started to emerge. And they're still emerging even now. 30 years after the 90s have finished. EI is still a under-researched area which we will touch upon a little bit in future lessons, but there's a lot of theories and research around what is emotional intelligence and whether it's something that you can even teach to begin with.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 1 - Micro Lecture 4
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Organisational Culture
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	11/04/22

Content

Most aspects of an organisational culture will be hidden from view. It's going to be the people who work there. What are their values, their feelings and beliefs? What influences the way that things are done at the organisation? Culture, of course exists at many different levels above and below the organisation. Starting at the top perhaps you have; societal, national, regional by industry by sector, by organisation. It might be that in a wider organisation you have a culture that exists at each individual business unit location. It might be by department or by function or programme, or even at the project level, where you will be responsible for that project culture.

The organisational culture is what your project will sit within, so understanding it is a really important part of being able to lead your team and to conduct a project stakeholder analysis. Different or changing organisational cultures will need you to adapt your project approach and your team culture is something slightly different, we'll cover that in a later lesson. Your team might be made of lots of people from different cultures, but that is termed as diversity. That's something slightly different to cover another day.

Organisational culture is a woolly thing to try and get your head around, especially if you haven't experienced many different organisations. I'm going to discuss three different diagrams that depict it, but they're all essentially the same. Depending on your learning style and your experiences you'll probably have a favourite.

Let's begin with the APM version. You'll note here that the APM terms things as climate and culture. Climate is above the ground. It's the trunk and the leaves and branches of the tree. It's the observable habits that characterise life in the organisation. So that's things like written documents, the vision statement, some key performance indicators, the organisational structure, the standards and processes that will be published that people have to read. The culture is the roots of that tree, it's underground, it's not something that you will see. Those are the values and beliefs that reflect the deeper foundations of the organisation. So it's people attitudes, how things get done, the rituals and routines that people might have, which probably won't be written down necessarily. It's all the different networks and groups of people, which will be very informal perhaps within the organisation, about how to get things done and who knows how to do what. It's about stories and language and how conflict and challenge is managed within that particular organisation.

A different metaphor, this time, where climate is above the surface of the water and culture is underneath. Climate as we talked about on the previous slide is written down. It's things which you can go and read and understand, and you'll be able to therefore adopt. Culture is something which won't be. You'll have to experience some time within an organisation, talk to the different people really understand their behaviours and what drives them. Therefore it's not something you can learn within a day.

If we take an example like this, document talks around. If we take the example of health within a workplace, so a climate example of what an organisation might do is offer on-site fitness classes, discounted gym memberships, healthy food in the canteen. But a cultural way of addressing health within the workplace would be at a much deeper level where it wouldn't necessarily be clear that it's happening even, and that would be trying to get each employee to understand how they have a healthy lifestyle that contributes to the organisations overall purpose. It would be about leadership setting the tone for how to lead a healthy lifestyle to try and nudge people towards some of the things which happen at the climate level. It's not that you only have a cultural level to address change or just a climatic level to address change, they work together.

The final diagram, if you're the type of person that prefers models with text rather than pictures and metaphors. So organisations have a potential, they have aspirations about where they want to get to and how they want to get there? Those can be put into two categories of climate and culture, like the previous diagrams. Climate is what people say and do. Culture is more implicit, it's what their beliefs are, how things normally get done regardless of what the climate might say about it.

Both of those two things, climate and culture, combine to create results, and this model would turn that as organisational engagement. Being able to have an organisation where the people within it understand the culture and it’s stopped being such an implicit value because everybody is on the same page and it's being modelled by the leadership so that people can follow the leaders demonstration. Creates a much more result driven, better organisation with improvements in business growth and value and performance ultimately.

Here's a list of some of the factors that can influence culture. I'd like you in a moment to pause the video to have a think through some of these. Have a look at each bullet point and try and relate it to an organisation that you know well. Maybe it's the one that you currently work at what?
Would your organisation say for each of these bullet points? For instance, on the amount of conflict encouraged, the organisation might say that they do not like there to be arguments and they expect their leaders to step in to stop things from becoming heated. That would be their climate answer. Then have a think about what the organisation is actually like from your on the ground perspective, because that is the culture. It might be that despite what they just said for climate, you know that what actually happens is that you go to meetings and there are raging arguments and there's nothing that the senior management like doing better than getting involved and stoking those arguments and making them worse. Just because something is said at the climate level does not necessarily mean that it actually happens at the cultural level. Where those two things do meet up, that's a really good organisation in general. So please pause the video and go through these bullet points like I just said.

It's worth pointing out that projects can sometimes involve multiple organisations. So does your customer, supplier or partner have a similar organisational culture to you? And have their project team that you're working with have a similar culture to your project team? Or do you need to adapt so that you can better match? Or do they need to adapt so that they can match your culture? All of those things need to be considered about. Culture is not static, and it's not a one answer one size fits all solution.

Slide 1

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MSc Project Management

Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities

Micro Lecture 1 – Motivation

Paul Moses

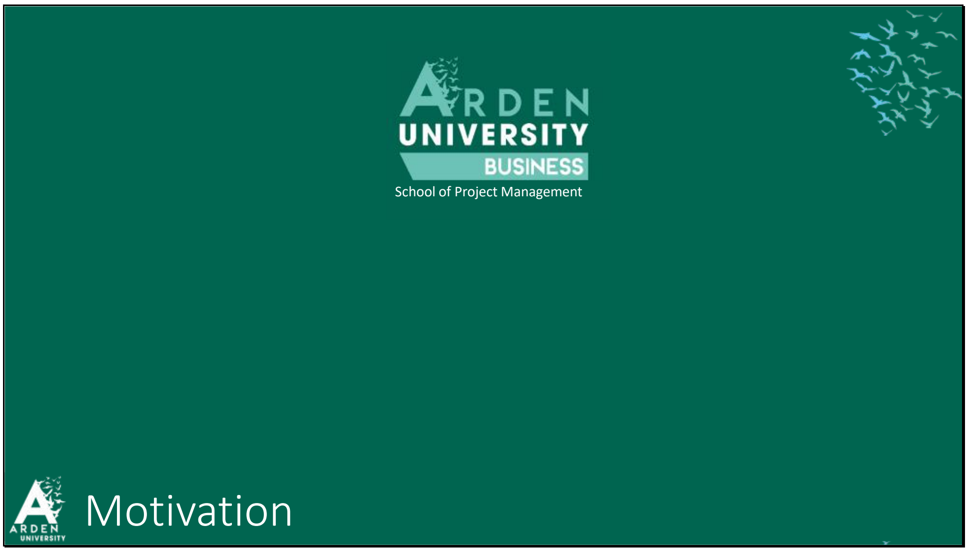
Slide 2

Motivation is the encouragement to do something. These might be short term or long term.

As a project manager you have a team of individuals all of whom are individually motivated, which you will need to address at some level to ensure your project has an effective team. The extra difficulty for a project manager is that, as the APM says, projects and their teams are transient endeavours, you likely won't have direct management responsibility for those in your team. So you likely have limited power to make big changes, but can change short term smaller things and try to influence the larger things decided by others.

Lets go through some models of motivation, starting with Maslows Hierarchy of Needs

Slide 3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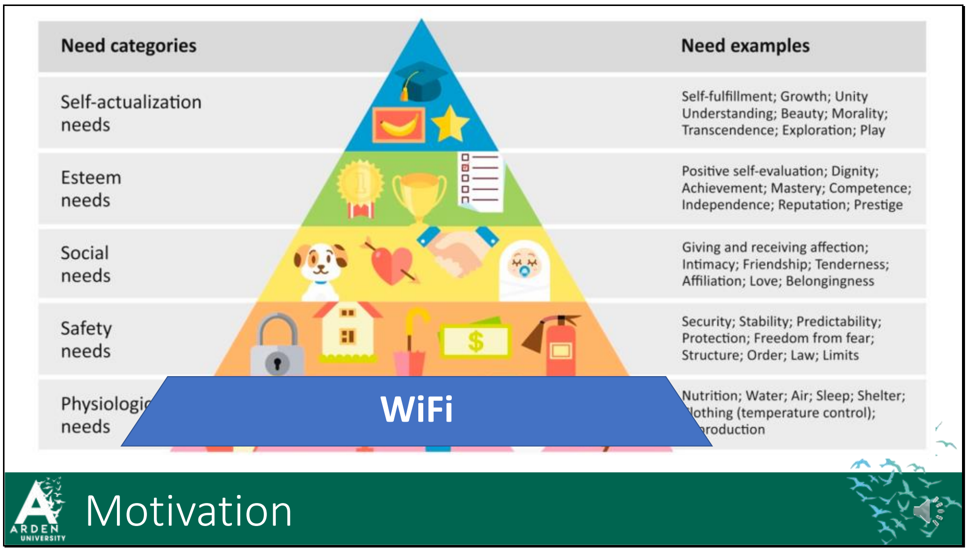
Motivation

Slide 4



Abraham Maslow was an American psychologist who wrote the “Hierarchy of Needs” theory. Maslow argued that humans are motivated with unsatisfied needs and more basic needs should be satisfied before more complex needs. There are five different levels of needs in his pyramid, which are physiological, safety, love/belonging, esteem, self-actualization needs.

Peoples behaviours can be explained by their needs, and their lives are a search to keep satisfying those needs.

Physiological Needs
Physiological needs ensure survival and so are universal for humans. In order to be motivated for higher needs, physiological needs must be satisfied. Eating food, drinking water, breathing air, sleeping, etc. can be given as examples. If you don’t have these you cannot consider or be motivated by the higher levels.

Safety Needs
After physiological needs are met, people will start to think about their safety. Safety helps people to create stability and consistency in a chaotic world. For example, when a person does not have a salary or economic safety, it is not expected that this person will be motivated for a higher purpose than money.. Alternatively, in unhappy marriages can be given as an example in this need.

Love/Belonging/Social Needs
Love and belongings are the needs coming after feeling safe in life. Humans are social animals, our primitive ancestors found it crucial to be a member of a group, in order to survive. Otherwise, exclusion from the group could be fatal. Therefore, in order to feel good, people need to be part of a group, love and being loved are necessary. The absence of this need can cause loneliness, social anxiety, and

depression. In the management perspective, one of the most critical needs is a feeling of belonging to the organisation and, for us, the project team.

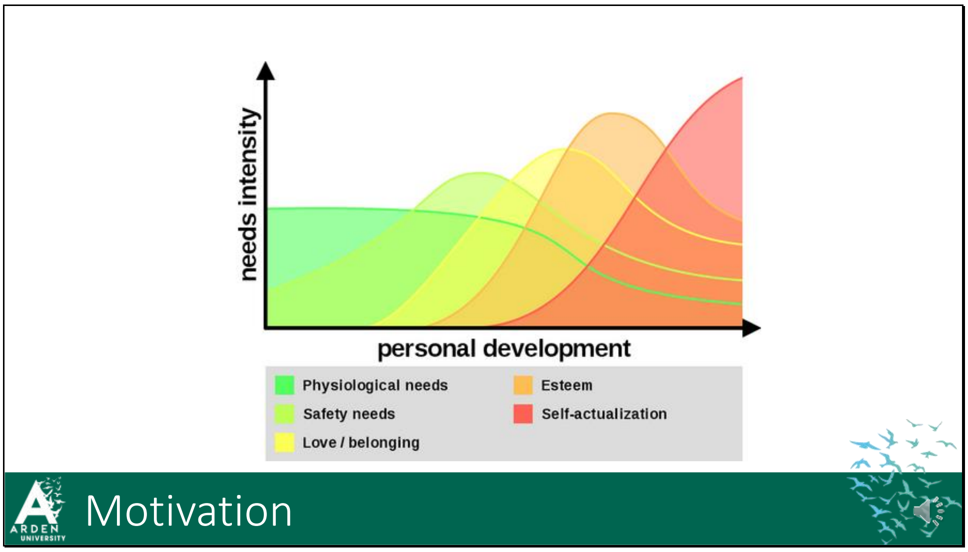
Esteem Needs
Esteem needs include two different categories. First is self-esteem which is coming from competence or mastery of a task. Second is the attention and respect from other people.

Self-Actualization
Self-Actualization is the final step of the needs, and perhaps the hardest to grasp. Maslow stated that “Even if all these needs are satisfied, we may still often expect that a restlessness will soon develop unless the individual is doing what they are fitted for. A musician must make music; an artist must paint, if they are to be ultimately happy.

So trying to meet these needs drive peoples behaviours. Very generally speaking you will find that those on your project team have the first two levels met. The latter levels are more subject to your influence in building a socially happy team, helping members to feel valued and allowing them to grow their careers/skills and do what they like to do.

Worth noting that Maslow also stated many behaviours have more than one motivation. He noted that “any behavior tends to be determined by several or all of the basic needs simultaneously rather than by only one of them.”

Slide 5



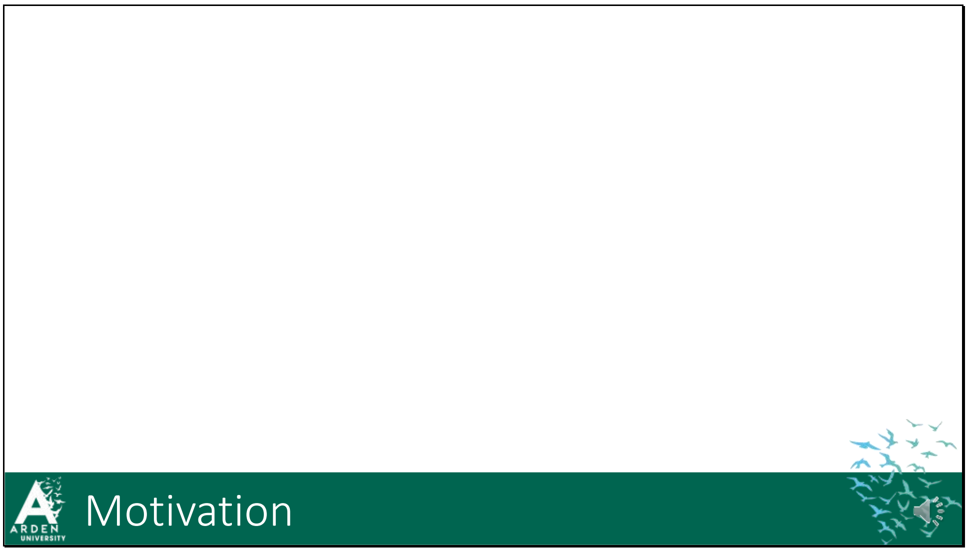
Thinking of it as a pyramid is perhaps a bit misleading, even though that's how you'll always see it portrayed

Maslow accepted that people could feel and satisfy different needs at the same time, stating that "In actual fact, most members of our society who are normal, are partially satisfied in all their basic needs and partially unsatisfied in all their basic needs at the same time. A more realistic description of the hierarchy would be in terms of decreasing percentages of satisfaction as we go up the hierarchy.

For instance, if I may assign arbitrary figures for the sake of illustration, it is as if the average citizen is satisfied perhaps 85 percent in his physiological needs, 70 percent in his safety needs, 50 percent in his love needs, 40 percent in his self-esteem needs, and 10 percent in his self-actualization needs."[1] Therefore, a more flexible and dynamic hierarchy of needs can be drawn.

Also though, as people becoming more secure in their personal development the more important the higher levels become to them

Slide 6



Its an old model that’s been around for a long time and so has drawn lots of criticisms
It probably holds true for individualistic societies better than collectivist societies where being the part of a group can be more important than self-actualization.
A persons age might impact the relative importance of the levels, particularly esteem in younger people.
Maslow generated this theory by studied 18 biographies of famous people to understand self-actualisation, that’s rather subjective and they were mostly white males (for example Thomas Jefferson, Abraham Lincoln, Albert Einstein, Aldous Huxley, Gandhi, Beethoven

There are counter examples
Some people, who have never experienced a lack of basic needs like physiological, safety, belonging needs, can under evaluate the importance of them.
Sometimes people can give up everything for the sake of their beliefs such as religions, ideologies, values.

But lets consider from a Project Management point of view

Slide 7

Self-Actualisation

Esteem

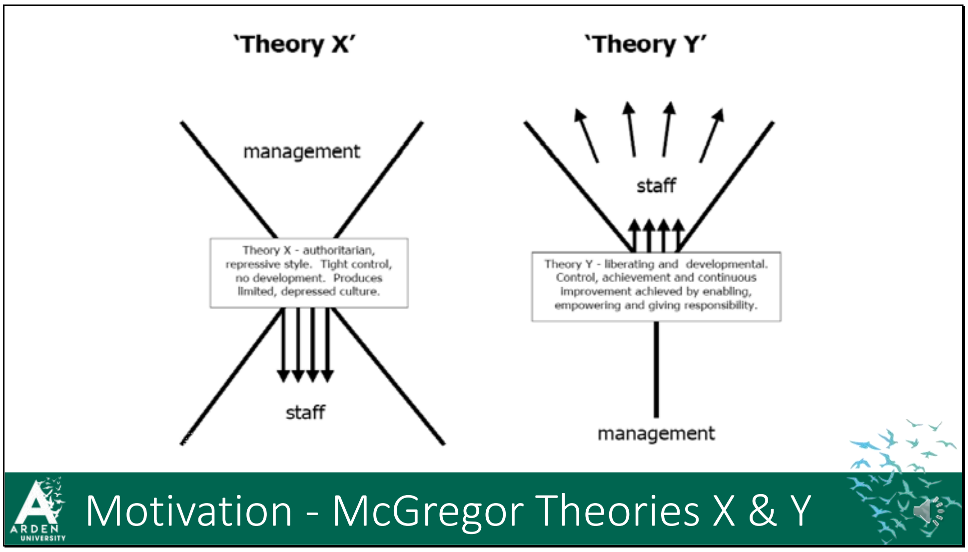
Social

Safety

Physiological

Motivation

Slide 8



'Theory X'
management
Theory X - authoritarian, repressive style. Tight control, no development. Produces limited, depressed culture.
staff
'Theory Y'
staff
Theory Y - liberating and developmental. Control, achievement and continuous improvement achieved by enabling, empowering and giving responsibility.
management
Motivation - McGregor Theories X & Y
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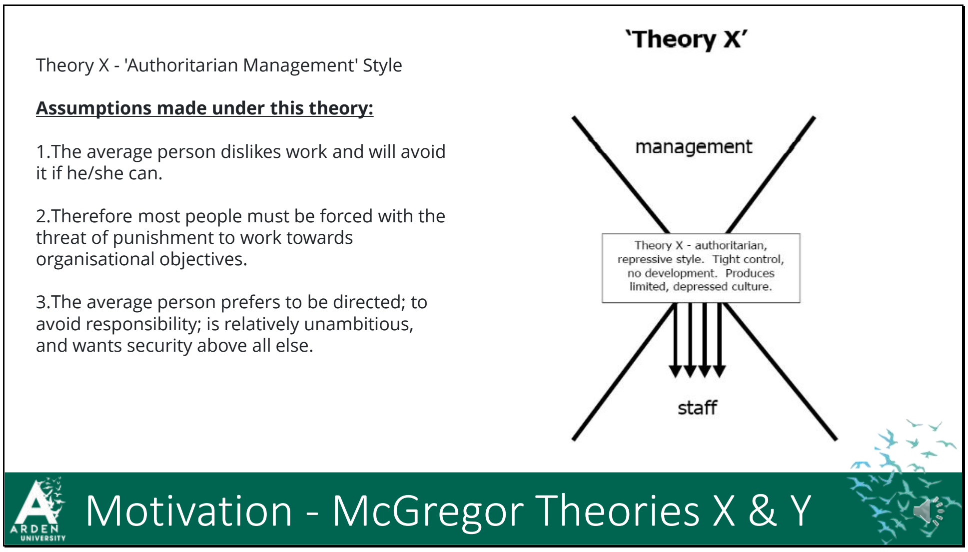
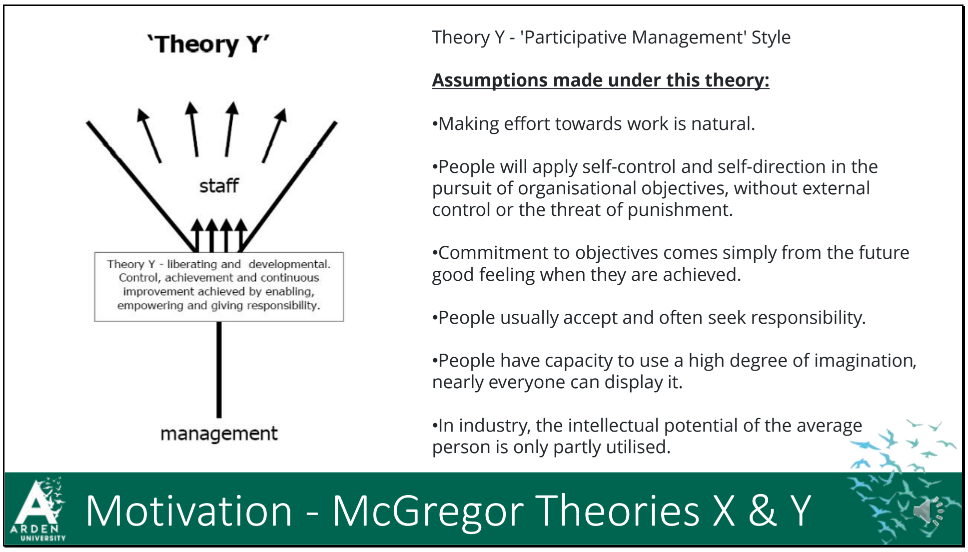
Slide 9



Douglas McGregor took the work Maslow did with the hierarchy of needs and grouped it into two theories on how people view human behavior at work and organizational life. McGregor called this Theory X and Theory Y; Theory X is focused on the "lower order" needs and Theory Y focuses on the "higher order" needs identified by Maslow. (4) McGregor suggests that management could use either theory to motivate employees but that the better results would stem from meeting the Theory Y needs

Slide 10



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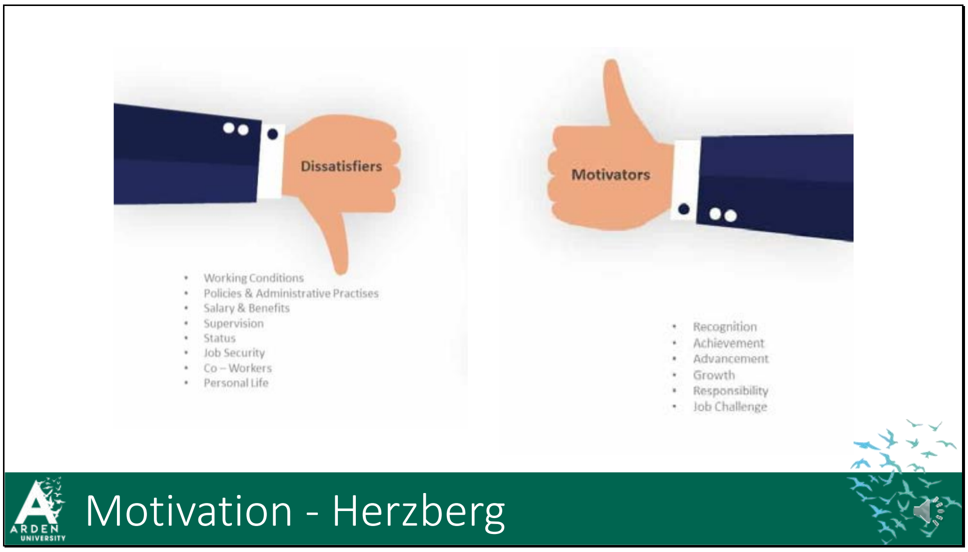
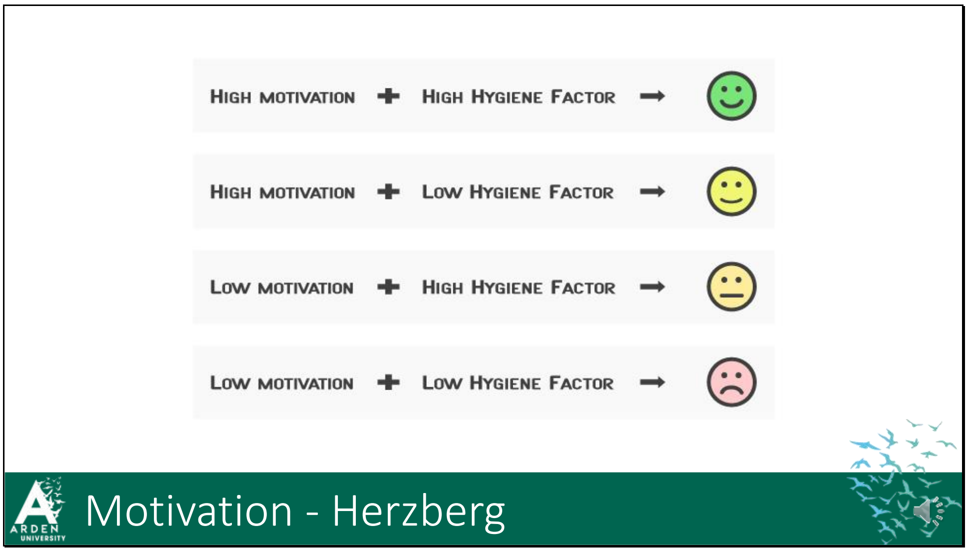


Herzberg's Motivation-Hygiene Theory. This theory focuses on the factors causing job satisfaction and the factors causing job dissatisfaction, and that they are different. Herzberg called the satisfiers motivators and dissatisfiers hygiene factors. Hygiene factors are in a sense maintenance factors that are necessary to avoid dissatisfaction but do not themselves provide satisfaction.

These factors should not be treated as opposites of each other. The opposite of satisfaction is not dissatisfaction, but rather, no satisfaction. Similarly, the opposite of dissatisfaction is no dissatisfaction

Despite its wide acceptance, the theory has its detractors. Some say its methodology does not address the notion that, when things are going well, people tend to look at the things they enjoy about their job. When things are going badly, however, they tend to blame external factors.
Another common criticism is the fact that the theory assumes a strong correlation between job satisfaction and productivity. Herzberg's methodology did not address this relationship, therefore this assumption needs to be correct for his findings to have practical relevance.

Slide 12



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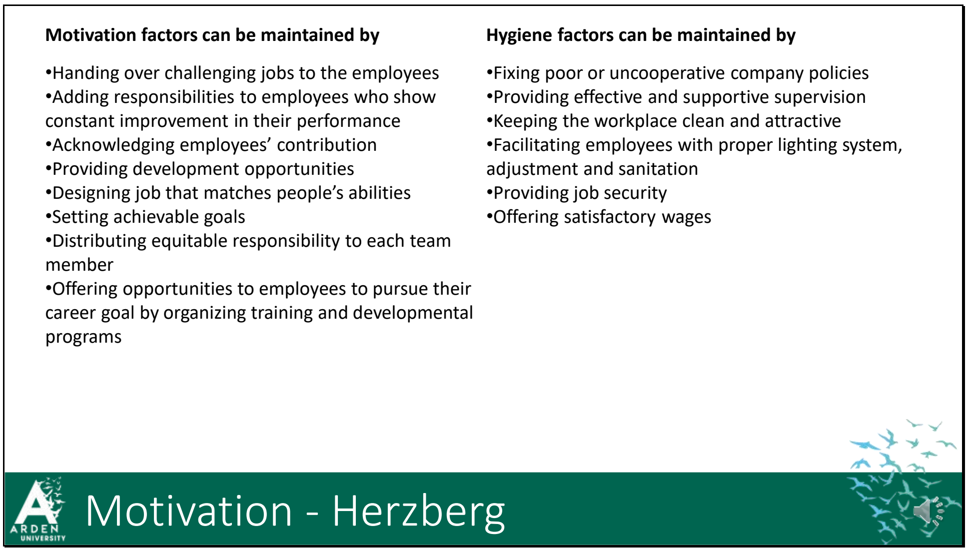
Slide 13

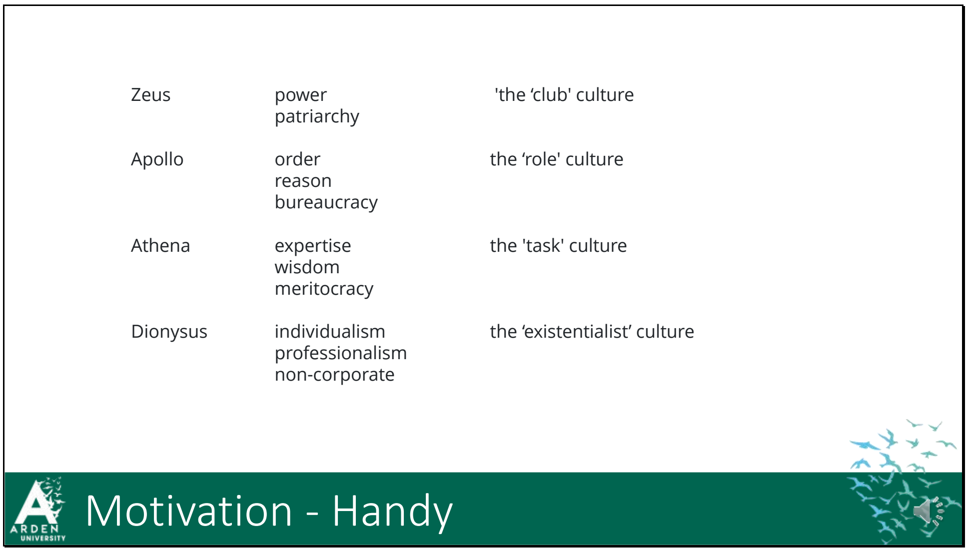


If you remove factors that build up dissatisfaction, people will stop complaining about their work. However, it doesn't mean that they will become motivated.
If you build up factors that motivate people, it will not stop them from complaining and leaving your organization eventually.

You must attend both types of factors if you want to keep your project team motivated. Moreover, it is important to fix hygiene factors before creating up motivators.

If you lead a team, take a little time with each of its members to check that they're happy, that they think they're being fairly and respectfully treated, and that they're not being affected by unnecessary bureaucracy.
You may be horrified by what you find once you start probing (bureaucracy, in particular, has a way of spreading), however, you may be able to improve things quickly if you put your mind to it.
Then find out what they want from their jobs, do what you can to give this to them, and help them grow as individuals.
If you do this systematically, you'll be amazed by the impact this has on motivation!

Slide 14



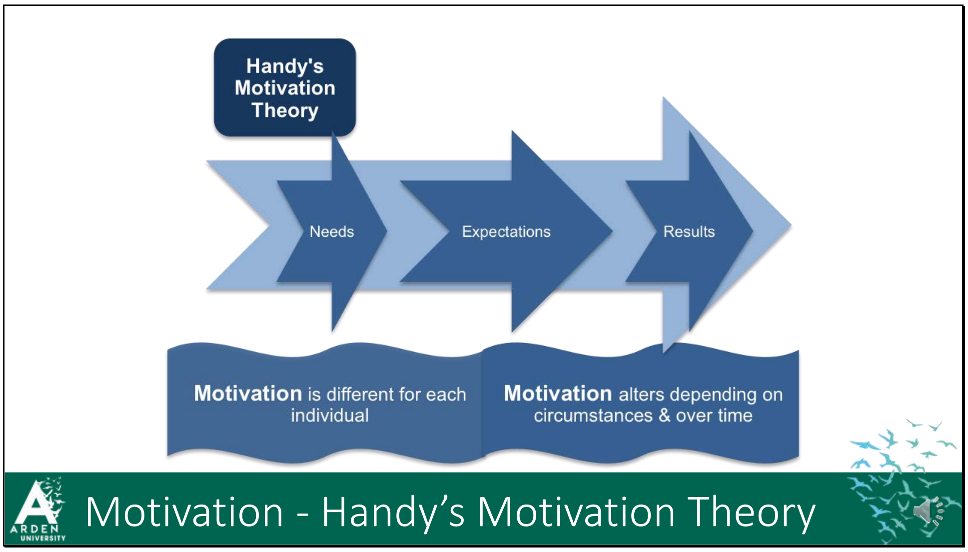
The final model I'd like to discuss is Handy's Motivation Theory

Charles Handy is regarded by many as the most advanced management thinker in the world. In the 1970s he published '*Gods Of Management'* using a metaphor of the Greek Gods to explain different organisational cultures. Not one to remember particularly but one you might like if you're into your ancient classics. There are so many models,

I always quite liked the types of team member based on Winnie the Pooh but anyway. Go google 'hundred acre wood team'

Handy was one of the first to identify that 'careers for life' were destined to become a thing of the past. He is seen as a visionary able to predict trends and changes on a global and fundamental scale.

Slide 15

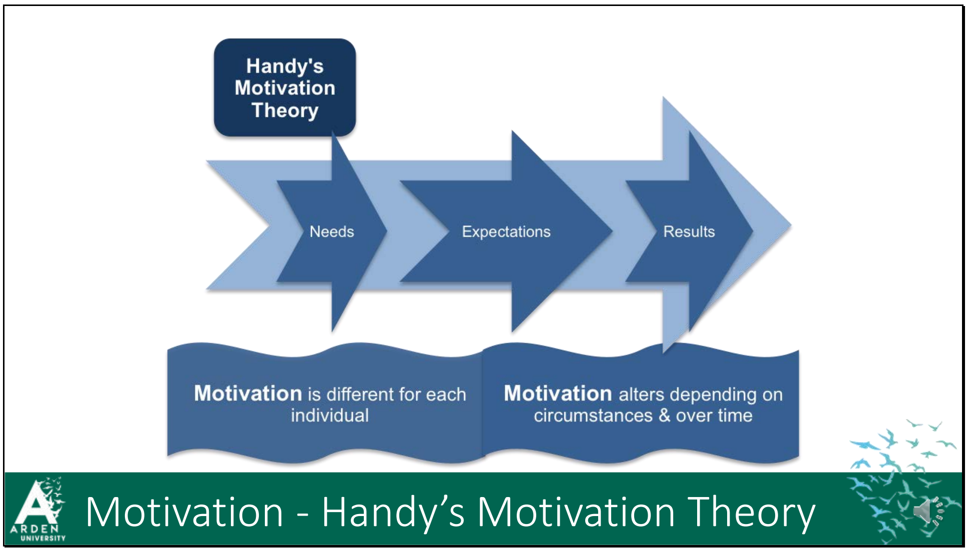


Handy's Motivation Theory is an extension of Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs, The simple **model addresses cognitive and external reference points** in a way that Maslow's original Hierarchy of Needs five-level model does not. attempts to **cater to complexities and variations in people's situations** beyond the reach of the original Hierarchy of Needs model.

our motivation is driven by a more complex series of needs than 'needs' alone, that is, our own interpretations and assessments form additional layers determining and determined by our response to our own needs and the effects of those responses:

Simple really, doesn't need any more explaining!

Slide 16

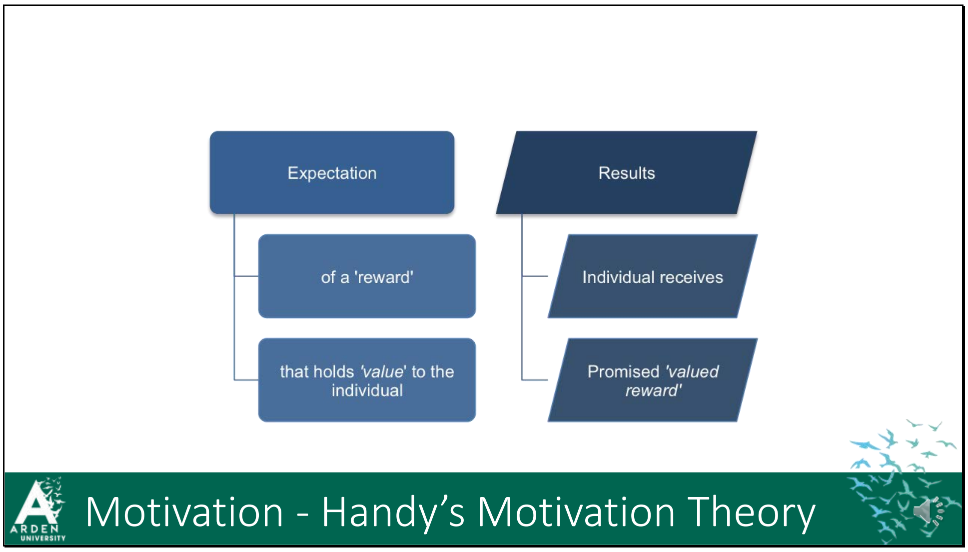


Needs

Maslow that you've seen describes the needs, from basic food and water – all the way to harder to quantify self-actualization. Some of the needs of your employees will not be able to be met by you as a manager, but you can help them to fulfill their need to feel satisfied or accomplished in the workplace.

One of the topics that often comes up within the needs category which can be addressed in the workplace is the need for affiliation. People naturally want to be associated with other people, especially if those people are successful or desirable in some way. So, when you are organizing the structure of your business, make sure you give your employees a chance to work with those around them. The friendships that develop from those working relationships are likely to be just as important as the work that is produced.

Slide 17



Expectation

What does the person in question expect to receive in exchange for their effort? How much are they going to be willing to invest in your project?

The expectation and expenditure are going to be closely tied, as people are naturally going to be willing to work harder to obtain things that they see as more valuable. For example, if you offer up a monetary bonus for a job well done, your team members are likely to work very hard to succeed IF they have a need for extra money. On the other hand, if the only expected reward is a handshake and a 'thank you', the effort put out is going to pale in comparison DEPENDING on who its from. From You? From the CEO? A knighthood from the queen?

Being singled out in front of the rest of the staff for the job that has been done will help an employee to feel empowered, accomplished, and appreciated. Social recognition is a powerful tool, and it is one that many people will work hard to receive.

This behavior is human nature, and it is unavoidable. Even the best employees are going to subconsciously work harder for things that they see as more valuable. While it would be great to live in a world where everyone simply gave their best effort all of the time regardless of expectations, that isn't going to happen anytime soon. If you want to get the most from your employees, you will have to give them the expectation of reward.

Results

Of course, you are going to have to follow through on the expectation of reward with an actual payoff when a job is completely successfully. Otherwise all trust will be lost. My story about Jon

Slide 18

That was a lot to pack in, but having all of these models in mind will help you to find the right way to motivate everyone that you lead.

Perhaps the key thing I want you to take away is to think carefully about the reward that you can offer for the work that is done within your company and project. Assuming that the standard paycheck which is received by your employees is going to be enough to keep them motivated is a mistake. Your staff can likely continue to receive their paycheck by doing just enough to get by – but you obviously want them to do much better than that. When you work hard to ensure that they have the proper motivations in place to strive for greatness, the whole organization can benefit in the end.

Slide 1

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Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities

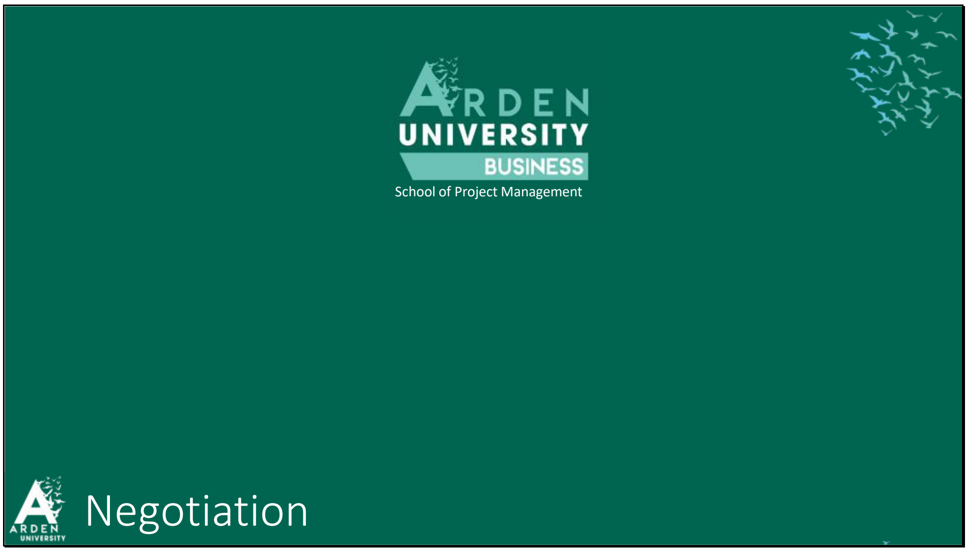
Micro Lecture 2 – Negotiation

Paul Moses

Slide 2

Negotiation is conflict too

Slide 3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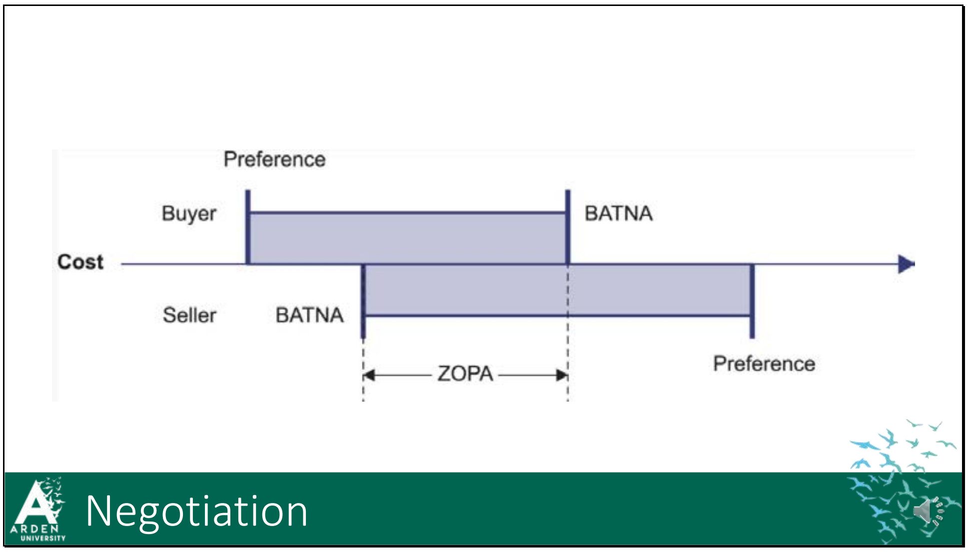
Negotiation

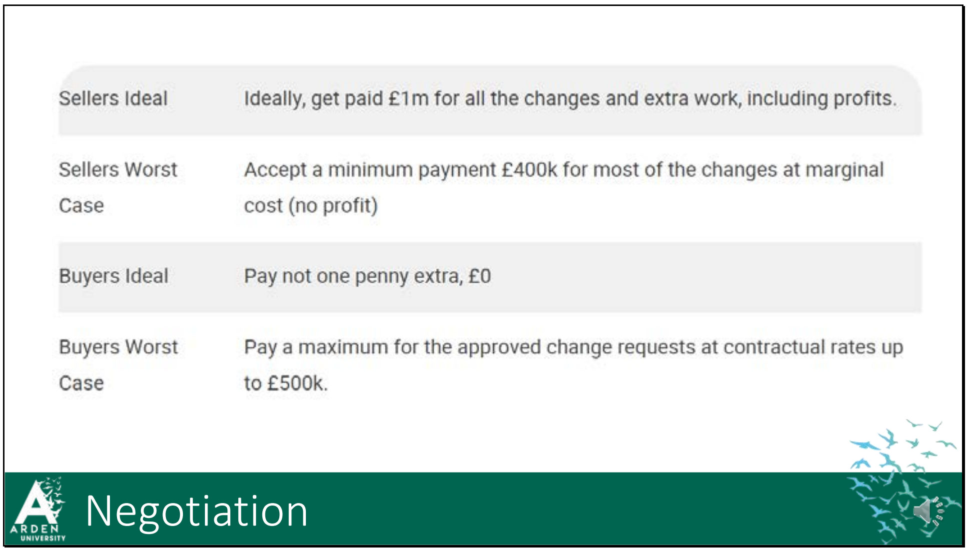
Slide 4



Zone of Possible Agreement (ZOPA)
Best Alternative to a Negotiated Agreement (BATNA)

Fisher, Roger and William Ury. *Getting to Yes: Negotiating Agreement Without Giving In,* 3rd ed. New York, NY: Penguin Books, 2011

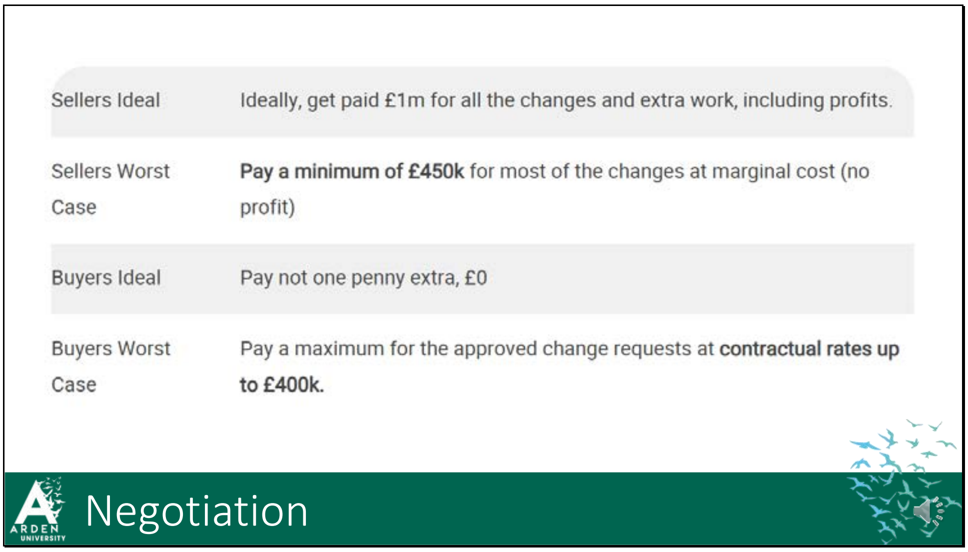
Slide 5



Sellers Ideal	Ideally, get paid £1m for all the changes and extra work, including profits.
Sellers Worst Case	Accept a minimum payment £400k for most of the changes at marginal cost (no profit)
Buyers Ideal	Pay not one penny extra, £0
Buyers Worst Case	Pay a maximum for the approved change requests at contractual rates up to £500k.

Here you can see we have a possible agreement zone between £400k, which is the minimum the seller is willing to accept, and £500k the maximum the buyer is willing to pay. It will help if you read getting to Yes to understand ways of reaching agreement without compromising relationships.

Slide 6



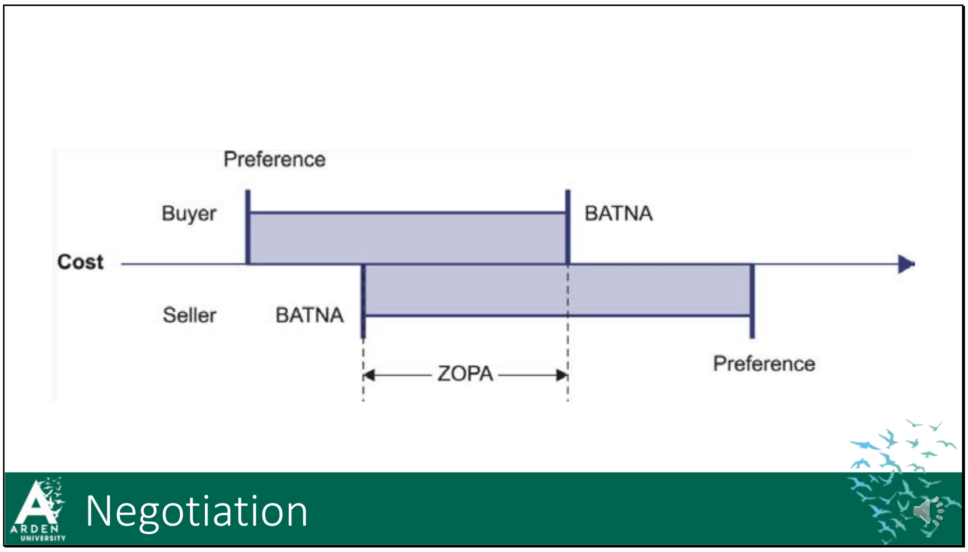
Sellers Ideal	Ideally, get paid £1m for all the changes and extra work, including profits.
Sellers Worst Case	**Pay a minimum of £450k** for most of the changes at marginal cost (no profit)
Buyers Ideal	Pay not one penny extra, £0
Buyers Worst Case	Pay a maximum for the approved change requests at **contractual rates up to £400k.**

In this case, we have no overlap between the £450k demanded by the seller and the £400k the buyer is willing to pay. We could spend all day in the room, but this negotiation will not reach an agreement. This is where we need a fallback plan, a Best Alternative to a Negotiated Agreement (BATNA). Ideally, we agree on this BATNA with Senior Management (and the Sponsor) before we start the negotiation.

For example
If we can’t agree this payment by the end of the week then we will have to take this to formal arbitration.

We should really agree on this BATNA with Senior Management (and the Sponsor) before we enter the negotiation room; otherwise, we run the risk of being unable to follow through on our plan and having to walk back into the negotiation with a significantly weakened position.

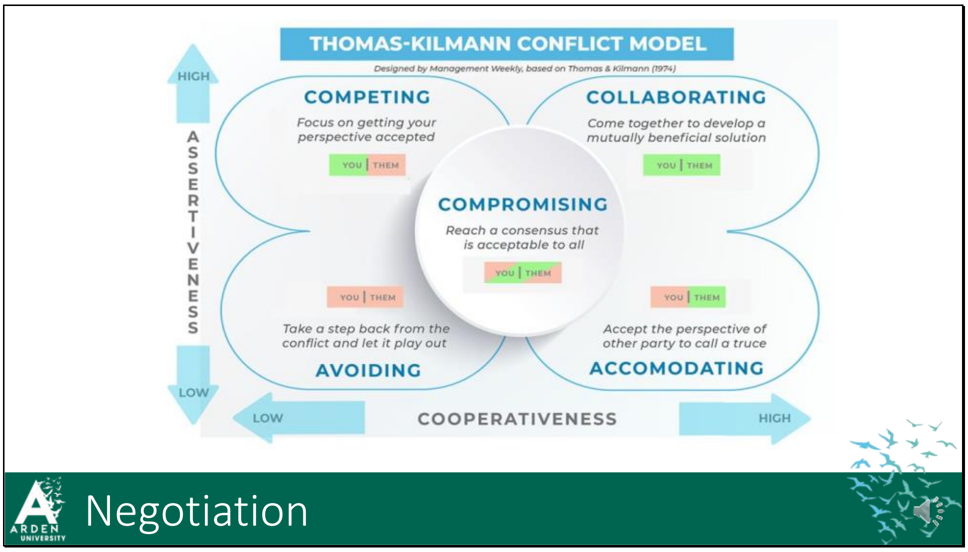
Slide 7



Think about your own ZOPA Zone of Possible Agreement (you probably do)
Guess at the other sides ZOPA

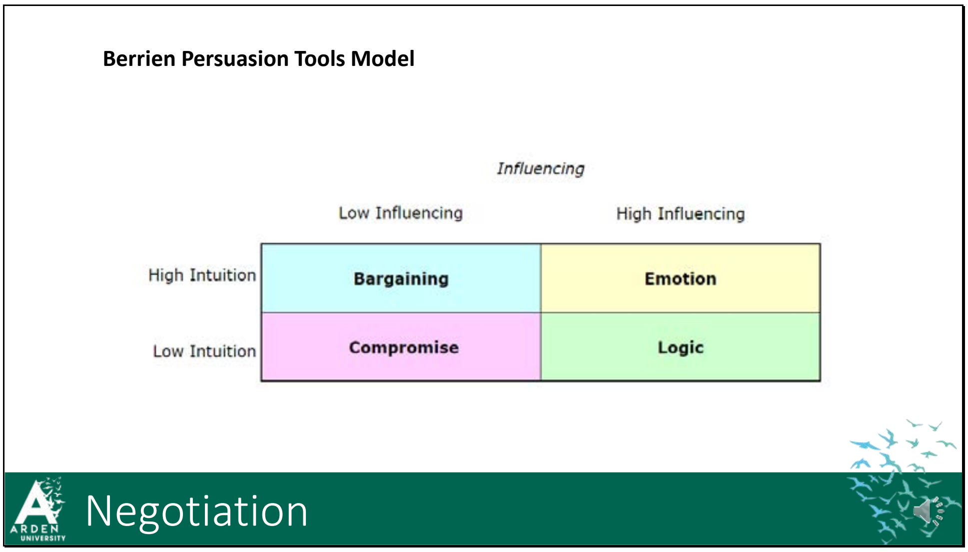
Have an agreed fallback stance/plan (the BATNA - Best Alternative to a Negotiated Agreement_

Slide 8



Conflict resolution too

Slide 9



Berrien Persuasion

Intuition

Intuition is a subject that some find natural and about which others are rather cynical. Its basing your methods and decisions on 'gut feel', emotion and other unconsciously-driven methods.

Working with low intuition means using more thinking, reasoning and rational approaches. This requires facts and cause-effect reasoning more than expressions of passion or concern.

Intuition can be a very useful ability, especially when it involves 'reading' other people, detecting how they are feeling and thinking. This may be through natural ability such as empathy, or using rational skills such as reading body language.

Influencing

Along the influencing axis, a high level of influencing implies greater amount of skill in changing minds.
Many people are not trained in influencing methods, yet may have a natural skill in this area. Others think using deliberate methods is counter-productive as the other person will realise an attempt is being made on them.

People who use logic are often mystified by persuasion using other methods as they find reason to be the only true way. Other people may

well see logic as cold and inhuman, missing out the all-important human element.
Good argumentation and the use of logic requires significant skills, especially if it is to be used to persuade. It is impersonal, and so requires less intuition.

Slide 10

Planning	Rarely		Sometimes		Usually
In my planning, do I . . .					
. . . consider a number of potential settlement options?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . look for areas of agreement?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . think about the long-term implications of issues?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . have a target settlement in mind?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . clarify my objectives?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . commit my plans to writing?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . consider the other party's objectives?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . consider the needs and interests of the other party?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . discuss my plan with others?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . know my concessions?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . plan the use of my concessions?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . plan the order in which items should be discussed?	1	2	3	4	5

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Negotiation

Slide 11

Face-to-Face	Rarely		Sometimes		Usually
In my planning, do I . . .					
When I finally meet the other person . . .					
. . . stay focused on the problem?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . ask questions and listen to the answers?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . clarify the issues before I begin problem solving?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . clarify the other party's proposals before I respond?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . test for mutual understanding?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . periodically summarize?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . explore the other person's needs and interests?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . acknowledge the other person's efforts?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . offer my own proposals?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . solicit proposals from the other party?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . make contingent concessions?	1	2	3	4	5
. . . avoid:					
• being judgmental	1	2	3	4	5
• fixing blame	1	2	3	4	5
• interrupting	1	2	3	4	5
• being patronizing	1	2	3	4	5
• being hostile	1	2	3	4	5
. . . follow my plan?	1	2	3	4	5

Negotiation

Slide 12

Review	Rarely		Sometimes		Usually
After the negotiation, do I . . . . . . set aside time to review and assess the results of the negotiation?	1	2	3	4	5

Negotiation

Slide 1


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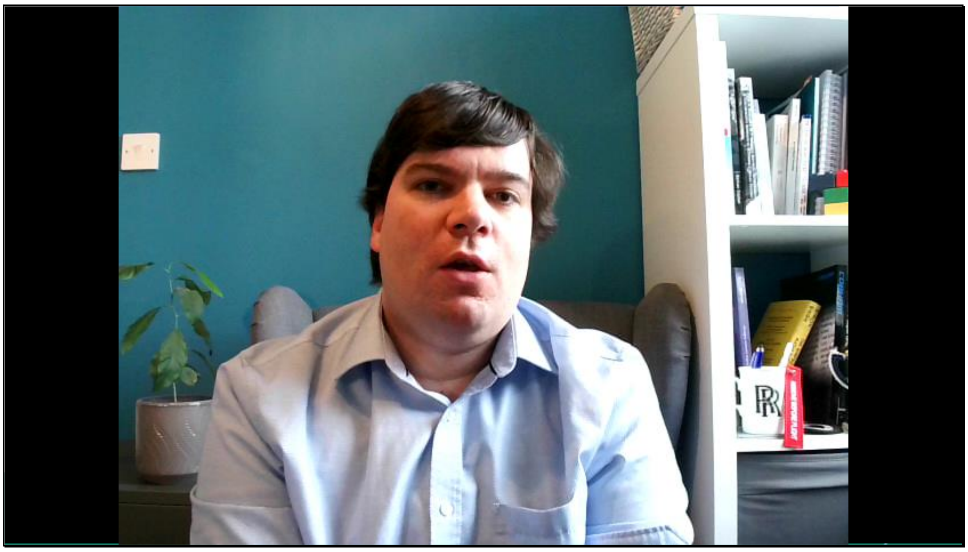
MSc Project Management
Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Micro Lecture 3 – Persuasion
Paul Moses

Slide 2



We talked about the **Berrien Persuasion Tools Model which said depending on your level of intuition and influence what to try and do: compromise, bargain, appeal to emotion or logic.**

But what are some ideas to try and increase your level of influencing ability, so that you can try to bargain or win an emotional argument?
Robert Cialdini is an academic and a popular author, it's rare textbooks become NY times list bestsellers! He claims there are 7 principles of persuasion

He says
"You and I exist in an extraordinarily complicated stimulus environment…To deal with it, we need shortcuts… Rules of thumb to classify things according to a few key features and then to respond mindlessly."

These automatic and unconscious shortcuts can be exploited.
People are susceptible — in both helpful and harmful ways.

Slide 3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Slide 4

1. **Reciprocation**
2. **Scarcity**
3. **Authority**
4. **Commitment**
5. **Liking**
6. **Social Validation**
7. **Unity *NEW***

Persuasion

Slide 5

Reciprocation

If you give people something they will feel obligated to give you something in return.

<u>Examples</u>

- Free gifts
- Useful information
- Praise
- Previous favours

<u>But…</u>

At what point does this become unethical or even illegal?

- Bribery
- Threats

Research suggests, in a business setting, 50% of project workers see obvious reciprocal favours as unethical.

Persuasion

Slide 6

Commitment

People want to appear consistent, tending to work hard to maintain commitments and justify earlier choices.

Publicly made commitments are often considered to hold more weight.

Examples

- Getting people to say ‘yes’
- Promises
- Written contracts
- Giving a reputation to live up to

But…

Sometimes people over time make multiple conflicting commitments.

Difficult to reach truly binding commitments

Slide 7

Scarcity

Things seem more valuable when quantity is limited.

Loss aversion: People are more concerned with what they may lose, rather than gain.

Examples

- Limited time/quantity
- Secrets
- Opportunities to undertake rare activities

Why

- Human history has been shaped by scarcity. Food, clothing, shelter, tools were all hard to come by without significant effort.
- The loss of a day's food could mean death, while the gain of an extra days food could lead to increased comfort but not greater life expectancy.

Slide 8

Friendship/Liking

People tend to trust people that they feel they know or like.

Examples

- Smiling
- Compliments
- Similarities
- Physical attractiveness

But…

May fail when attempts to be nice seem overly eager.

Such a frequently used method that some become suspicious of people who try to be friends

Persuasion

Slide 9

Social Validation

People find it difficult to deviate from group opinion, especially when outnumbered – occasionally leading to groupthink.

Examples

- The Asch experiment
- Sales figures
- Online reviews
- Others experiences
- Previous project estimates

But…

Can equally validate a negative

"Fewer than two-thirds of projects meet their goals and business intent".

Some may purposefully rebel against social norms

Persuasion

Slide 10

Authority

People tend to be obedient toward authority, or the appearance of it

Being **in** authority - Positional

- Following orders of superiors
- Titles, uniforms, suits

Being **an** authority - Personal

- Expertise
- Credibility
- Qualifications

Persuasion

Slide 11

Unity

The more we perceive someone as a part of "us," the more likely we are to be influenced by them.

Similar to a combination of Liking and Commitment, though moving beyond surface level similarities

Examples

- Shared identity: Family, location, religion, profession
- Shared experiences
- Co-creation (The Ikea Effect)
- Us against them

Persuasion

Slide 12

When I first learned about these I loved them. Even those which felt like statement against the obvious became useful after I really started thinking about them or read the examples in Cialdinis book.

When you think about any time you persuaded someone, you can link back which of these 7 principles were at play, it feels like they explain everything!

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 1 - Micro Lecture 4
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Organisational Culture
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	11/04/22

Content

Most aspects of an organisational culture will be hidden from view. It's going to be the people who work there. What are their values, their feelings and beliefs? What influences the way that things are done at the organisation? Culture, of course exists at many different levels above and below the organisation. Starting at the top perhaps you have; societal, national, regional by industry by sector, by organisation. It might be that in a wider organisation you have a culture that exists at each individual business unit location. It might be by department or by function or programme, or even at the project level, where you will be responsible for that project culture.

The organisational culture is what your project will sit within, so understanding it is a really important part of being able to lead your team and to conduct a project stakeholder analysis. Different or changing organisational cultures will need you to adapt your project approach and your team culture is something slightly different, we'll cover that in a later lesson. Your team might be made of lots of people from different cultures, but that is termed as diversity. That's something slightly different to cover another day.

Organisational culture is a woolly thing to try and get your head around, especially if you haven't experienced many different organisations. I'm going to discuss three different diagrams that depict it, but they're all essentially the same. Depending on your learning style and your experiences you'll probably have a favourite.

Let's begin with the APM version. You'll note here that the APM terms things as climate and culture. Climate is above the ground. It's the trunk and the leaves and branches of the tree. It's the observable habits that characterise life in the organisation. So that's things like written documents, the vision statement, some key performance indicators, the organisational structure, the standards and processes that will be published that people have to read. The culture is the roots of that tree, it's underground, it's not something that you will see. Those are the values and beliefs that reflect the deeper foundations of the organisation. So it's people attitudes, how things get done, the rituals and routines that people might have, which probably won't be written down necessarily. It's all the different networks and groups of people, which will be very informal perhaps within the organisation, about how to get things done and who knows how to do what. It's about stories and language and how conflict and challenge is managed within that particular organisation.

A different metaphor, this time, where climate is above the surface of the water and culture is underneath. Climate as we talked about on the previous slide is written down. It's things which you can go and read and understand, and you'll be able to therefore adopt. Culture is something which won't be. You'll have to experience some time within an organisation, talk to the different people really understand their behaviours and what drives them. Therefore it's not something you can learn within a day.

If we take an example like this, document talks around. If we take the example of health within a workplace, so a climate example of what an organisation might do is offer on-site fitness classes, discounted gym memberships, healthy food in the canteen. But a cultural way of addressing health within the workplace would be at a much deeper level where it wouldn't necessarily be clear that it's happening even, and that would be trying to get each employee to understand how they have a healthy lifestyle that contributes to the organisations overall purpose. It would be about leadership setting the tone for how to lead a healthy lifestyle to try and nudge people towards some of the things which happen at the climate level. It's not that you only have a cultural level to address change or just a climatic level to address change, they work together.

The final diagram, if you're the type of person that prefers models with text rather than pictures and metaphors. So organisations have a potential, they have aspirations about where they want to get to and how they want to get there? Those can be put into two categories of climate and culture, like the previous diagrams. Climate is what people say and do. Culture is more implicit, it's what their beliefs are, how things normally get done regardless of what the climate might say about it.

Both of those two things, climate and culture, combine to create results, and this model would turn that as organisational engagement. Being able to have an organisation where the people within it understand the culture and it's stopped being such an implicit value because everybody is on the same page and it's being modelled by the leadership so that people can follow the leaders demonstration. Creates a much more result driven, better organisation with improvements in business growth and value and performance ultimately.

Here's a list of some of the factors that can influence culture. I'd like you in a moment to pause the video to have a think through some of these. Have a look at each bullet point and try and relate it to an organisation that you know well. Maybe it's the one that you currently work at what?
Would your organisation say for each of these bullet points? For instance, on the amount of conflict encouraged, the organisation might say that they do not like there to be arguments and they expect their leaders to step in to stop things from becoming heated. That would be their climate answer. Then have a think about what the organisation is actually like from your on the ground perspective, because that is the culture. It might be that despite what they just said for climate, you know that what actually happens is that you go to meetings and there are raging arguments and there's nothing that the senior management like doing better than getting involved and stoking those arguments and making them worse. Just because something is said at the climate level does not necessarily mean that it actually happens at the cultural level. Where those two things do meet up, that's a really good organisation in general. So please pause the video and go through these bullet points like I just said.

It's worth pointing out that projects can sometimes involve multiple organisations. So does your customer, supplier or partner have a similar organisational culture to you? And have their project team that you're working with have a similar culture to your project team? Or do you need to adapt so that you can better match? Or do they need to adapt so that they can match your culture? All of those things need to be considered about. Culture is not static, and it's not a one answer one size fits all solution.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Module Overview
Module	Developing People Leadership and Capabilities in Project Management
Lesson	1
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	2022

Timestamp	Content
	Welcome to your new module: Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities. In this module we are going to explore some of the more people based, soft skills of Project Management, rather than the hard technical skills you've seen in other modules about processes, methods and tools. 'Hard' and 'soft' skills get used as terms but don't start thinking that it's the same as 'difficult' and 'easy'. Leadership, leading people isn't easy. People are complex with different needs, motives, abilities, expectations and emotional states. People are flexible and adaptable, a great strength, but also unpredictable and changeable. Part of your role as a leader is to get the best from people who work for and with you; you have to consider all these issues in deciding how best to lead individuals and teams. Leaders also have to champion and look after the needs of their organisation whether it's a business, charity, public sector service or anything else. You have to enthuse about and promote the purpose and objectives of your project team, and organisation. You'll likely know me from other Project Management modules, I'm Paul Moses the module leader, I'm looking forward to taking you through this learning. I've led a number of teams in industry, large and small, for a few weeks to 2 years, with members of varying disciplines and skill levels. I've taken people through the heights of sparkling successes to the depths of despair and back again, and that was just one project team over the course of a week! Getting your group of individuals to form a team, led by you, is paramount to succeeding in delivering your project and having fun along the way. Regardless of whether you are using Waterfall, Agile or a hybrid methodology you will have to lead teams. Also though, understanding leadership really helps in understanding yourself and how you are best led by others too. This particular chapter of your learning journey is perhaps broader than your previous modules, but it's all focussed around a central theme. We'll cover the: How teams develop and leadership styles Motivations and negotiation skills

	Organisational dynamics and communities of practice The social context of teams and leading them in a virtual environment Stakeholder management and engagement Looking after your team, in terms of stress and their professional development Diversity Managing the talent in your team Regulatory environments, ethics and internal politics Sustainability and responsible project management So welcome again, it's great you've made it this far, not too much of your Masters left to go! Let's get started.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 3 - Micro Lecture 1
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Organisational Structures
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	11/04/22

Content

I'm going to talk through the different sorts of organisational structures, both new and old, that you might find yourself working within. For the majority of people watching this, you're probably going to be working in a matrix type environment. It's the most common and therefore I'll dedicate the most time to talking about that.

The first is a hierarchical structure, and I'm sure that you've all seen this before, it's relatively straightforward and obvious. This used to be a very popular organisational structure. If you go back 100 years pretty much the only structures that existed were these. In it employees are grouped with every employee having one clear supervisor and that supervisor has another clear supervisor and it goes all the way up the chain to the very top. This is still the dominant mode of organisation in large companies or organisations such as governments or organised religions. They're all hierarchical, with different levels leading up to one person in charge. Within these structures, communication will typically flow from the top all the way down to the bottom, which means that it's slow. Innovation can stagnate, engagement suffers, and collaboration is very difficult to achieve. Normally this type of organisation has got a lot of bureaucracy and it's quite slow to react. And that's perhaps why in more modern times this type of hierarchical structure has been moved away from more and more into other things.

A divisional structure. This is a type which is normally laid over the top of all of the other types that we're going to talk about. This is where an organisation splits itself into different divisions, where each division has got its own organisational structure, or hierarchy in this particular case on the screen here. Normally companies or organisations are split into some kind of factor, and generally that's either geography or a certain type of product or customer. So within this each division has a full complement of staff to be able to perform as its own small business and this is used particularly where there's a parent company that owns multiple smaller companies which are all standalone. The main advantage of this is the independence of each other and that the failure of one company would not hinder another company within the same overall parent. But it's not perfect either, there's operational inefficiencies from splitting up all of these different structures. It means that each of these structures, the substructures, has got its own HR department, accountancy department for instance, and it's quite common for companies to try and downsize their staff by combining all of those into one central function and move away at that point from having a true divisional structure.

The matrix structure. This is I would argue the most common structure in business today, a matrix. In this type of structure, but reporting relationships are set up as a grid or a matrix rather than in a traditional hierarchy. It's a type of organisational management in which people with similar skills are pulled together for particular tasks or projects resulting in more than one manager to report to. Sometimes that's referred to having a solid or a dotted line to report into, or other times it's a project or a functional manager, or sometimes that's called a vertical manager and a horizontal manager.

For example, you might have all of the engineers within an engineering department reporting to a chief engineer, but each of those engineers might be assigned to different projects, and also therefore reporting to a project manager as well. So that's your project and your functional or dotted and lined. So therefore you'll have some engineers that might have to work with multiple managers in their job. They'll have a functional and a project manager, or they might even work on multiple projects at once, in which case will have many project managers to report to and their functional manager.

If the last matrix organisation looked complicated then this one just looks trippy. This is a network structure. The idea behind it is that you have the lines there representing who people talk to, so it's all based around trying to draw out the social network of the organisation. So the reporting lines for some people will be multiple, it's all the people that they need to report upwards to and for some people it will just be the single one person that they report upwards to. It all depends on the particular situation at the particular time. So this is obviously quite flexible. It does not have as many tiers. There are still some dots there in the middle that represent the final chain in the communication, who are the people who are in charge. The real disadvantage from this is just the complexity, that is not really an organisational chart that you can put in front and get anybody to understand. But it does show the lines of communication, it's perhaps potentially just a useful diagram to have within your organisation. But running a structure and the whole organisation just based on lines of comms can be quite challenging.

This one is a horizontal, or sometimes it's called flat, structure. This is an organisational type that's mostly adopted by smaller companies or startups at the beginning of their journey. It's almost impossible to make this kind of structure work for a larger organisation with many employees and projects. The important thing about this flat structure is that many levels of middle management are gone, they're eliminated. Employees are trusted to go and make their own decisions for themselves. They still have a hierarchy, they have a single line hierarchy straight to the boss of the company, but the decision making has been shared out so teams are able to react much faster and feel much more accountable for the decisions that they make. That means that things can be very very quick and agile. But it is not something that would work for a larger company, as soon as you have more than say 20 maybe 30 employees, you're going to have to have more levels of hierarchy and the single boss is not going to be able to do everything.

Finally, here are two organisational structures which are much newer and rarer. Although they are perhaps becoming more and more adopted and you'll see them in the future. The first is a flat-archy, which is a terrible name, but it's a mix between a hierarchy and a flat organisation, so a flat-archy. These are types of companies which have a bit of both, it might be that they have a strong hierarchy and they have small breakout teams with a flat structure for a project that's needed. Or it might be that they're a very flat organisation and they have small breakout teams which adopt a hierarchy depending on the project and what it is that they need to do. This is a type of organisation that is very dynamic. They're changing their entire structure to suit whatever it is they're doing at that particular time. So it's very dynamic, but it is at that point very disruptive for the individuals involved. The idea behind the flat-archy is that it's putting innovation at the heart of everything the organisation is trying to do. Traditionally you would have had a R&D, research and development, team who were off doing the new exciting things, but it was a team that was static, it was always the same. In a flat-archy that changes, you're having a brand new team of people set up whenever some new idea comes along, so you're not using the same people for all of your innovation. You're being very dynamic and using different people.

The next is a holacratic organisation, and there's not really a diagram that describes it but there is an attempt at one. This is a type of organisation structure which is being used by quite small companies and startups again. The idea behind it is that there are no job titles, there are no managers, nobody is in charge. There might perhaps be an owner, a boss, but there are no levels of middle management whatsoever. But it's different from a flat structure because there are no job titles, there's nobody telling you what to do. The most famous example of a holacratic organisation is the computer game company Valve, although admittedly in the last year or so they've started to move away from a holacratic type. But about a year ago at Valve, if you worked there, nobody told you what project to go work on. You could just have a look at what was going on in the company and go and join in on whatever you thought looked best or what you wanted to do. And if you wanted to start up your own project you just went and talked to the boss, and if you could convince him of the business case then they'd start that project too, and then maybe some people would come and work on it with you if they wanted to. That obviously will not work as soon as you have more than say 20 employees. At that point, any higher number, what I've just described would be utter chaos. But it's worked for Valve so far and there are a few other examples of holacratic organisations. It might become the defacto method for new startups.

Let's go back to talk about matrix organisations some more. Matrix organisations are probably the most common type in business now, but particularly organisations that have projects and project managers, are even more likely in my opinion to be a matrix type. But there are different sorts of matrix organisations and it's very important for you to understand which type it is that you're working within.

The first is a functional matrix, so from a project manager point of view this would be called a weak matrix organisation. In here you can see you have the grey boxes who are just staff members. You have the white boxes who are staff members working on projects and you have the dotted line about who's coordinating the projects and it's the functional managers. So maybe you have a software team, a hardware team and a coding team. It's the functional engineering managers there who are controlling all the projects. There aren't really project managers. If there were project managers, they would have very, very little power. It's all being decided by the functional manager.

The opposite to that would be a project based matrix, or from a project manager point of view a strong matrix organisation. So you can see in here the functional managers have gone,there aren't any. If there were they would have very very weak power. You can see that you only have staff here who are working on projects. There aren't any other people who aren't working on a project and it's the project manager that sits at the top of the chain for that project, making all the decisions and coordinating. They have complete power over the staff. They are the line manager of all the different types of people and skills that are working on their project.

And then the middle ground, what would be called a balanced matrix, or a functional and project based matrix.Within here you have the functional managers who have some staff in grey who are working on projects and you have the project managers themselves. The project managers all also have a manager of project managers, that's their functional manager. And you can see that the projects are being coordinated across all of the groups. So you have a project manager who has staff assigned from all the different functions that the project requires and those people are reporting into the project manager, but they are also reporting into their functional manager. This balanced matrix is the ideal, it's great in practise but as soon as it turns into reality you will find that the balance is not perfect and it will either tip to being a weak or a strong matrix where the project manager has power or a functional manager has more power.

That power is described within these charts. So on the left hand side you can see that the more project based an organisation is in its matrix, then the more power or authority the project manager will have, and if it's a purely functional they will have low, and the balance would be in the middle. But as I said, the balance normally tips one way or the other and the project manager finds himself either higher or lower than the functional manager. And why does that matter? Well it's about resource availability, getting people onto the team and being able to get them to do what is needed. If you are a project manager in a weak matrix, then you are relying on the functional manager to provide the people for your team. You are not able to tell them what to do directly. You are going to have to rely on your persuasion and influencing skills to get things done. You do not have any positional authority in that weak matrix.

Conversely, if you're in a project based organisation, so a strong matrix, then you're going to be more directly in charge of the people on your team. You're going to be able to tell them what to do. You're not going to have an engineering manager, a functional manager pulling people off to go and do different projects because you will have more power than that functional manager. And that is why the balance part and how it will tip from one to the other is so important, because if it turns out that actually it's not a balanced matrix you're in but a weak matrix, then you're going to be constantly fighting for resources and having to do a lot of negotiation just to try and get your project done.

I never really liked working in industry as a project manager in a matrix organisation because what was supposed to be a balanced matrix would very often turn into a weak matrix where the functional manager had a lot more authority and power than myself as a project manager. But it seems to me that matrix organisations actually create the perfect setting and encourage power struggles. In a hierarchical environment, a power struggle is just not allowed, it's illegitimate. There is a boss who is up above who sets the tone, they tell you what to do and therefore you can't have a power struggle with anybody else. But within a matrix type organisation the boundaries of authority and responsibility are so overlapping that you have a lot of people involved. If your project, as project manager, is not yours to fully control, you have got numerous other functional managers who also feel responsibility for getting the project done. And at that point you have a power struggle where different people are going to try and maximise their own advantage and the only way to do that is to put other people at a disadvantage.

Friendly competition is fine, that can be encouraged. But it very often becomes much more than just friendly competition with one party actively trying to push down the other party to get an advantage. I think one thing that helps everybody involved in that kind of power struggle is to take the higher picture institutional point of view. Otherwise it can become very personal very quickly. The other thing that you have to consider within that kind of power struggle in a matrix, is the top manager and what they are doing to help or hinder the power struggle on party A or party B. It's quite easy for a project sponsor perhaps to start taking the side of the project manager or functional manager in terms of who they communicate with more, who they put up for promotions more. Or just the types of instruction that they are giving, they might not be sharing all the information. With both parties equally. And at that point it becomes very, very difficult. It's normal for it to become whichever project manager shouts loudest in that environment as to who is going to go and get their resources, because it is the functional managers who are in charge of deciding where the different resources go, and so it's just the project manager who shouts loudest.

There's nothing to be done to solve any of that problem in a matrix organisation for a PM if I'm honest, but it just highlights even more perhaps the importance of being able to negotiate and persuade people.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 4 - Micro Lecture 1
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Social Context
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	11/04/22

Content

In the APM body of knowledge this is topic 3.1.2 and it's about two pages on what is a vast subject. Systems thinking applied to social networks is a Masters degree module all in its own right. But here the basics and just enough to inform your practise as a project manager.

The first and most straightforward thing to talk about are social network diagrams. I would fully recommend that you construct a social network diagram of any project that you are managing. In fact, we're going to go through a trial example of doing one later in the lesson.

All it is, is looking at your stakeholders who in systems thinking terminology are actors, and it's working out the relationships between them. So who is funding who? Who is telling who what to do? Who is passing information to one another? Or advising each other? And you'll come up with a diagram that looks something a little bit like this. You might have more actors, maybe you'll have less because you'll be lucky. But you will know who is interacting with who and how, and once you can see all of those connections between each other, you can start to see which stakeholders or actors you can influence and how that will have a knock on effect to other people.

Taking a social systems perspective of an organisation will fill your head with a picture that looks something like this. Organisations are made up of lots of different people in a vast network of who talks to who. People will be in a group and they will talk to the other people in their group mostly, but then groups will talk to other groups. And it might not be based around what is on an organisation chart, you might find that people interact with each other socially in ways that you do not expect. There will be certain people that talk to others at the water cooler. Or there will be groups of people in a virtual environment who set up a slack channel to have a chat. There will be the people that bump into each other in the corridor or people that happen to go to the same regular meeting where they get to talk and discuss things. Or maybe they have lunch together. Or the group of people that go after work for drinks, will go go-karting or paintballing or whatever it might be. Understanding that social network as well allows a project manager to seek ways of influencing which are quite subtle and are not necessarily going to be known. It's going to allow you to open up extra lines of communication and therefore information which you might not have by playing with the strict organisation context rather than the social context.

Not many people necessarily think of the social context, and that's because they think of the organisation as a machine. Bear with me on this. Organisations are not machines, and although that might seem obvious, we still understand organisations and how people work in them from this machine perspective. The idea of an organisation as a machine has become so ingrained and pervasive in management practise and theory in the last 50 years that it's hard to even be aware of it sometimes. The mechanical perspective draws attention to the structure and processes of an organisation. The organisation is seen as a structure that can be broken down into even smaller discrete units, from an organisation to business units, departments, restructurings, holding transformations, workgroups, roles all the way down to individual tasks. The mechanical perspective puts a strong emphasis on efficiency, on time saving and optimising the flow between units. It shows in words that we still use today, like human resources, change implementation, job descriptions, escalating issues and work packages.

If you explore the roots of a mechanical perspective, you can attribute much of it into scientific management or Taylorism. This approach to management was developed by Frederick Taylor between the 1880s and 1900s, and it was firmly based on economical efficiency. Although scientific management was developed primarily to optimise repetitive work in factories, it quickly spread into other domains and in the following century it would give rise to modern day practises like lean manufacturing and Six Sigma. The most significant criticism of scientific management, and the mechanical perspective behind it, is the total lack of consideration for human needs and interactions. People are reduced to a collection of skills that are mapped to a standardised job description and then they're trained to become better at those skills. When teams are formed. This is done with a checklist of skills in mind. There's no consideration for the unique dynamic of potential members and the needs they bring and the beliefs that they have.

You might be thinking "so what?" "So what if I think of an organisation as a machine rather than as a social system?" Well, we're part of and we're all influenced by social systems and that might seem obvious, but it often clashes with the common practise, which is informed by thinking of the organisation like a machine. For example, when employees are compared or rewarded based upon their individual performance it completely disregards the social environment that they operated in. "You did a good job, you met your targets", but what were the surroundings around you meeting your targets? Are they even considered in how the bonus is awarded? It's when senior leaders like a CEO are rewarded massive bonuses for the success of their organisation, because it's just assumed that their personal traits or behaviours have made that success possible. When candidates for jobs have to participate in all sorts of individual assessments, ranking and grading their skills. Things from IQ tests to personality tests, and those determine whether they're a good fit. But note the word 'fit' is a subtle example of how the mechanical perspective is still quite ingrained in work. When the composition of teams is frequently changed at will by outside parties, whether that's HR or a project sponsor or a resource manager who's changing who happens to be in your team. That normally doesn't have any clear involvement from the rest of the team, it's again not taking the social system into account. When organisations change they essentially present a plan and they expect everybody to follow it. That is not creating the right setup for employees to actively take part informing that plan and getting buy-in. Organisational change essentially boils down to management presenting the plan and telling people what to do like, it was in input into a machine rather than input into a social system where there are thinking minds behind it. And it's when organisations sidestep team building of any kind in favour of just getting started as fast as possible. Instead of considering team building as a real foundation to successfully having a team that gets going. Sometimes team building can be taken as a nice to have, and "once we've hit the first milestone or two then we'll all go out for a team building exercise", but that really mistakes the whole point of building a team and having a strong foundation.

So how can a social systems perspective help us? Well, a social systems perspective gives us a different and arguably more complete lens to understand what change is and how it can be facilitated. Quite a few examples to talk through. For instance, it's easier and it's more convincing to do something when peers are doing it also. So, when you need to change something, roll out a change initiative, have lots of people involved and change it together. The more people are involved and recognise themself as a stakeholder talking to you, the more likely it is that others will follow. Our social nature means that emotions and beliefs spread through the social network. When a few people complain about something, soon after everybody starts complaining about that same thing. And the reverse is also true, so model different behaviours with a few people and see how it spreads throughout the rest of the team. When it comes to teams and communication, how people interact is very, very important. So work hard to interact in a way that allows every voice to be included. Spend time together to build up a psychological safety between different people so they will freely express their opinions without any real fear.

Resistance to change, resistance is a social process, it's not a trait that's inherent to people, although individually some people might be a bit more conservative than others. The social desire to follow peers is likely to override any hesitation and initial resistance. When it comes to hiring people instead of trying to hire the best people, work hard to create psychologically safe and motivating environments where everybody feels that their voice matters. It's considering how teams make people more than people make teams. And to that point, having a toxic employee either being hired into your company or put into your team is a really bad thing. So regardless of how good they might be, a toxic team member that drags down the rest of the team needs to be moved out of your project team.

And as a downside, the social systems perspective explains something which we need to perhaps be aware of as well. The social nature of individuals means that we are very highly susceptible to manipulation through social influence. So the point that we can actually start to make ethically bad choices. Groupthink is a good example of this, where everybody just goes along with a bad or potentially even unethical idea, because everybody else is already doing it. An extreme example of this are cults ultimately, but it happens within organisations as well. Take Uber as an example. There used to be, and perhaps maybe there even still is, a culture of real machismo and sexism within Uber, which was set from the top perhaps, but because it was acceptable at the top it started to filter down. And that's an example of where groupthink makes something, which most people would describe as unethical, become something that they just automatically did because it was acceptable and everybody else was doing it. And that is a social systems perspective that answers why that happens.

So the APM gave two pages and I've done 10 minutes on this topic, but in reality we could do nine or ten more lessons on just this alone. But hopefully from this short introduction you've begun to understand how the social systems perspective can help you to understand change. How change happens and how you can help facilitate change. And you've recognised how much of your thinking, but also other peoples thinking, is still subtly influenced by a mechanical perspective in organisations Bear that in mind when you're trying to convince or persuade somebody about something, they are using a mechanical perspective whether they realise it or not. Lastly, you've probably begun to realise just how deep this rabbit hole can go, once you start applying insights from social systems to your own work, project management, society, the way that you operate within society, you could go on and on about this for a long time.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 5 - Micro Lecture 1
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Stakeholders
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	12/04/22

Content

Who has an interest or a role or is impacted by the project? If somebody is one, two, or all three of those things, then they are a project stakeholder. It's a term that was first used in the 1960s. Businesses have shareholders, they own the companies economic value and management has to be responsive to the shareholder. Stakeholders instead are almost the opposite, they own social value. They don't necessarily own anything, but are impacted by the project and therefore also need to be considered. In project management terms, that means balancing the efficient creation of a solution or change, which is the economic side, and the people support for those outputs, which is the social side.

So as a stakeholder is somebody who is either interested in your project, or who is impacted by your project, or both of course, then the first thing you need to do is work out who those people actually are for your project. And that can be quite a unique task depending upon your unique project, so it's easiest to talk through some examples instead.

Let's take a website development project. The stakeholders to this, first you have the internals, you have the people working upon it, the people who will be taking your teams output and using it themselves within the business and you obviously have the sponsor as well. External to your project though you have all the people who will be users of the website. You'll also have anybody else that the website impacts, so that will include things like, perhaps the search engine companies that will pull up your website. It might include people who are conducting Google searches who do not necessarily want to see your website come up. There will be all kinds of different stakeholders which you will need to consider, and then you will look at who is actually important to the project.

Let's take another more complicated example of building a stadium for the Olympics. So this isn't the entire project of the Olympics, which has too many stakeholders to really get your head around, but just building the stadium. The stakeholders for this obviously are going to be your team, the contractors who are going to build the stadium for you, the suppliers of all the different bits of equipment which you're going to need. There is a huge supply chain involved with building something as complicated as this stadium. But then you will also have other stakeholders. You'll have the people who are going to use your end product stadium, but that's not just for people who are going to visit it to spectate on sport. That will be the people who are going to work there. The facilities team, the cleaners, the stewards. Where are they going to go and have their meals and their break times? But also the other companies that are going to be involved. So who is going to run the cafes? Who's going to serve the drinks for food? Everything else? The merchandising? They're all stakeholders to the project.

Equally, the surrounding area is going to have its own bunch of stakeholders that might have an interest or be impacted by your project. What about the people whose houses have been knocked down potentially to build your stadium in the first place? The planning authorities that have given you permission, or not yet, to build your stadium. And the surrounding environment, the other people who are going to live near to the stadium who might be annoyed or worried about the levels of noise from the events. Or it's going to be local businesses who are maybe more in favour of the project because they're going to have much more passing trade. Transport links would be another stakeholder. As you can see, the more complicated the product is, the more people it touches either directly or indirectly or unintendedly, the more complicated identifying your stakeholders will be.

A good way of working out who those stakeholders are, particularly internally but it works just as much externally as well with a bit more thought, is using a social network diagram that you might remember from a previous lesson. If you can conduct that exercise to create the diagram of the network, then you can see who might actually be interested in your project. Over and above the initial obvious people who have a team for sponsor, you'll start to think about the other people in the organisation who might be funding it or giving instructions without you necessarily realising.

Regardless of whether you've identified the stakeholder or not, that stakeholder will have an engagement activity with your project. And this pyramid gives you an example of the model of how stakeholders might engage. Starting at the bottom, you might just have a stakeholder who will observe your project, they won't have that much interest in it necessarily, they're not going to actively do anything, they're just going to sit back and watch the stadium being built down the road from them perhaps. You might have stakeholders which go a step further, they will actively follow your project. They will be interested, they will read newsletters that you might send out to them, they will want to follow your progress. You might have stakeholders that take a step further and they start to actually actively endorse your project, they help you in a way. And then at the top of the levels you're going to have people that actually contribute to your project, obviously that's the team who are helping you perform for project, but you might have external stakeholders that want to give input and take that step to being a contributor. You will then have the leading type of stakeholder, which is you, you are yourself the stakeholder you are leading the project. And at the very top pf the tree, the owner, so that is the project sponsor or steering group ultimately. But as you reach the higher levels of pyramid, you're going to have to have an increasing personal relationship to be able to effectively engage with the stakeholder. Somebody that's just observing your project, you don't need to do anything. Somebody that's just following it, you don't need a personal relationship. But once you get to the very top level, especially with the sponsor as we've talked about in the past, you need a very deep personal relationship to really be able to make the most of that.

Once you've identified who the different stakeholders to your project are, that's the hard bit done. Then it's considering these different three factors to each stakeholder.

So the first is how much power does the stakeholder have to change things on the project? Are they able to tell you what to do, like the sponsor can? Or are they not able to really tell you what to do at all and it's just going to be whining that nobody has listened to?

The next is how interested they are in the project. Is it somebody that is actively going to be watching because they're very interested in what happens in the project and the outcomes of it? Or is it somebody that has very, very little interest whatsoever?

And then finally. How likely is it that they are supportive of the project. Are they for or against your project? Does your project make them happy or sad ultimately?

So you might have a stakeholder who very much cares about the output of your project because it's going to vastly improve their life and therefore they are going to be supportive of the project. Equally you might have somebody on the outside who doesn't like what's going on with this project whatsoever, and is going to demonstrate against it in the most extreme case. So it's how happy or sad, how likely are they to support your project?

So power, interest and support of the three key things that you have to consider on every single stakeholder you have, because that will impact on what you do with those stakeholders.

Starting with two diagrams which are broadly the same, but it's nice to see a few different examples. A lot of stakeholder management will only consider two of those factors.

I told you about, so the power and the interest. And that's important for sure, but it's not the whole piece. If you're looking at a diagram which is just power and interest, then you can map those different stakeholders to this kind of chart. Who has a lot of power and a lot of interest, because you're going to want to look after those stakeholders quite carefully. And who has no interest in no power and therefore you need to do very little except just to keep a brief eye on them. You will see lots of different stakeholder models which are effectively these charts, but they all have different names for what you do with them. As you can see here, you've got one side that says 'handle with care' and one side that says 'keep satisfied' and that's the same thing, I don't think it matters too much what labels you apply to all of these different parts of the diagram of a model. But it's very important to look at the power and the interest and map those across to see who it is that you need to pay attention to, or just keep informed, or not pay attention to.

And here is another example of the same thing. Power versus interest as for two axes on a chart, and you're plotting your stakeholders against it. What's interesting on this one is that some of these are quite generic job titles or roles within a project where they're broadly probably going to sit within these different quadrants on the chart. You obviously need to think about this yourself, rather than taking it as gospel, but in general you will hopefully have a sponsor or executive who is high power, high interest, if they're not interested in your project then that's a real problem. You will have customers who might be very low interest but very high power in telling you what to do. Equally, you might have the people on the team so testers, suppliers, developers. They will have varying levels of interest and also varying levels of power, but are never probably going to reach the heights of power that your sponsor might have.

Of the three factors, power, interest and support. You've seen some models of power and interest and they didn't go into the negative, and that's because there's no such thing as a stakeholder with negative power or negative interest, they just have low power or low interest. But when it comes to support, people will be for or against your project and therefore you do have positive support and negative side. This is a type of diagram that tries to take account of that, it doesn't have interest in it whatsoever, it takes power as your up-down axis and your horizontal axis has broken itself into a positive and a negative. So you have your opponents and you have your supporters.

Perhaps the most complete way to show a stakeholder analysis would be to use a cube so a three dimensional chart where the three dimensions are the three factors of support, power and interest (or engagement as it says on this diagram rather than interest). I'd argue that's hideous, it's too complicated, I'm not sure that very many people see three dimensional charts and really understand them straight away, you have to think quite hard about them compared to a 2D chart. But this also has some rather interesting labels attached to the different stakeholders. Maybe you need to go full screen to see them properly. The first one to bring up is the sleeping giant, as it's termed on this diagram. So that's somebody that has a high level of power and a high level of support for your project, but they have a very low level of interest. So that is somebody that if you can coax them into action, into being slightly more engaged and interested in your project, then that's somebody that you can turn into a real champion that can help you.

The converse to that is a saboteur. And you'd like to think that in project management there aren't people out to actively sabotage you, but I'm afraid that's not always the case. So a saboteur would be somebody that has higher levels of power and interest in your project, but they have very low support. They're not happy they're anti- your project. They're going to try and get in the way. You need to identify those people and try and nullify them somehow.

You have the saviour, up near the top. So somebody with high support, high power, high interest, ideally that's your project sponsor.

And the last one, which I thought was quite interesting on here is the tripwire. So that is somebody with low support and low power, but they are anti- your project, they're not interested in your project. That is somebody that you need to pay attention to still. You might just be observing them, but if you happen to do something that awakens them and trip, you effectively set off a tripwire. Then you might have turned that stakeholder into something that can get in the way, so it is worth considering what are the things that you need to dodge? Who are these people that are tripwires just waiting to cause you a problem.

A better way of showing that rather than a cube which is horrible, might be this instead. So this is your power and interest grid like I showed you earlier, but they've added in some colours to the labels for the different people. So you've got green people, grey people, and red people. For people who are supportive, neutral and resistant. That's a much easier way to show on a single page who your stakeholders are and all three factors I think.

Which leads to this ultimately, this is a redrawing of the last diagram I just showed you. So you have power versus interest (or influence versus interest, it's the same thing). And you're just putting happy, medium, or sad faces on for whether they're supportive or not. It's the same thing, there's no reason to make stakeholder management look more complicated, and more professional, than it needs to be. If smiley faces work, there's no reason not to use them.

Stakeholder analysis is a really vital tool for anything that you're undertaking. Whether that's you as a project manager of a project, or whether it's just your career. This is an example of a stakeholder analysis of somebody's career. Who are the people that are interested in their career with power to promote them? Give them a better salary? And who are the people who are not? That can be a useful thing to do so that you can understand all the different people around you and how they might impact upon you.

Stakeholder analysis is of great value, when it's used to shape how the work is planned, delivered and governed, and if it doesn't then stakeholder analysis is a bit of a waste of time and a distraction. The composition of governance boards for processes, for gaining agreements on solutions and benefits, general communication strategies and the risk management process are just some of the aspects of project based working, that need to be designed in the specific knowledge of your stakeholder landscape.

Remember that that's a landscape that is very dynamic. It can change at a moment's notice, and you need to be aware of that and plan it into your risk strategy. And it's also the unique insight viewpoint that you get to look at how politics and shifting alliances and shifting sources of power really work in relation to your project. And if you can get to the bottom of that, tap into it and try and manoeuvre so that your project lands favourably with the people that matter, then that is a real project management talent. Something which will put you in good stead for trying to get your project to succeed.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 6 - Micro Lecture 1
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	APM Leadership
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	11/04/22

Content

As a break from always sending you to read a section of the APM body of knowledge, this time I'm going to do it for you. The APM would say, and I completely agree, leadership is needed at all levels within a project setting. The sponsor will communicate the vision to the project manager and set the high level expectations. The project manager will take those expectations and set them out in more detail to the team members. They'll also make decisions and provide feedback to the team. The project manager will be responsible for trying to get the best out of each individual on the team, giving them directions and support. The team members will share responsibility and they'll work collaboratively, and in some cases they may take a small leadership role within the team trying to deliver tasks or maybe work packages even.

The APM would then go on to say within the body of knowledge, that I'll ask you to have a quick look at later, that leaders have to be situational in their style. In certain cases they may need to be directive and in others they might need to be coaching or mentoring. The APM also says that over time leaders, if they're being successful, can hope to try and delegate more to the team and allow a team to be self-managed. And at that point the leader has moved into a more servant leader type role.

None of that is necessarily very new information for you. Not since you've started this module and studied through all the lessons up until this point. But it might start to help codify what leadership is. I wouldn't take any one person's advice on what leadership is. It is a very woolly area and it's very difficult to pin down, and it's going to be very context driven and it's going to be very personal. You are going to have to come up with your own definition of leadership ultimately, but seeing the APM's is probably quite a good start point.

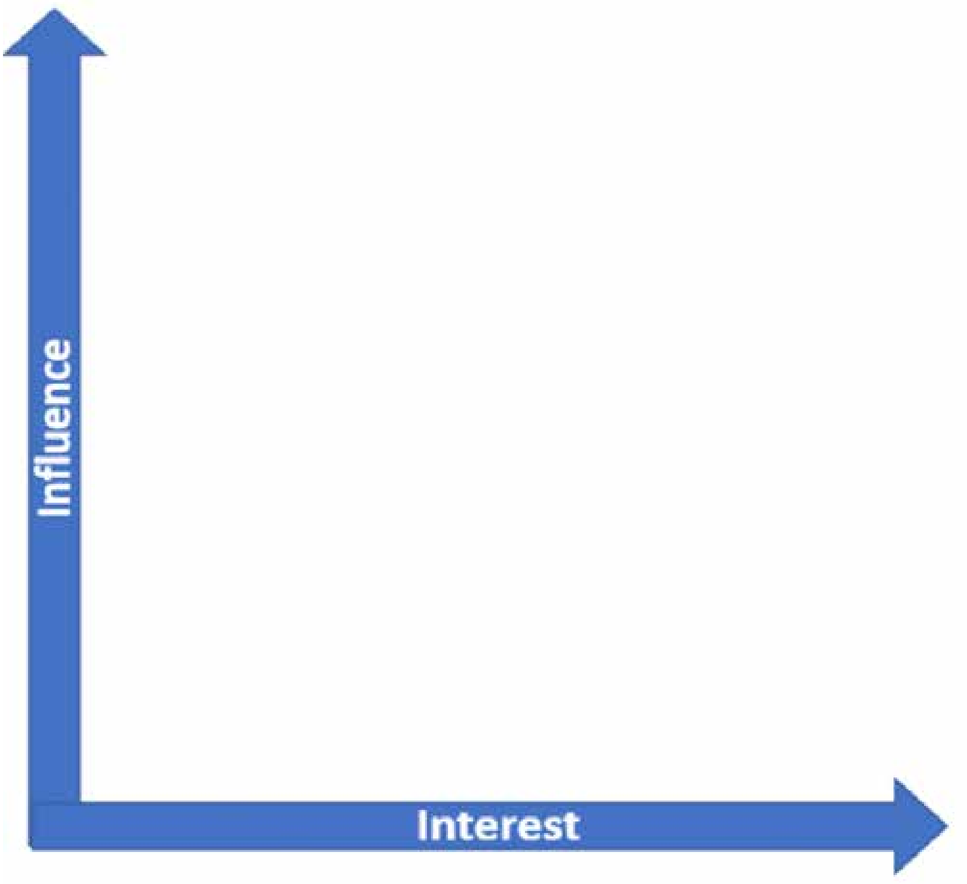
The next part of this lesson I'm going to ask you to do some reading. And I wouldn't normally tell you that in a micro lecture, but I want to be upfront and honest with you, it is quite a lot of reading. I'm going to ask you to read chapter three of something called the ‘Power of Project Leadership’ and Chapter 3 is relatively long. There are seven keys to project leadership according to the book, and in other books they would be seven small chapters. However, I would urge you to read it, it's all really important and useful stuff. And it can go into more detail and explain leadership in a much better way than watching a few 5 or 10 minute micro lectures is going to be able to do.

But there's one particularly practical element from the book that I really want to bring to the forefront and make sure that everybody sees. It's also a subsection from Key 7, and being the last of the keys, that's perhaps the one that you're most likely to skip over, I hope you don't, but I want to show you this one just in case.

It's the time management triangle and it's from Key 7 which is called ‘working with intent’. Working with intent is perhaps the number one thing that I would want my project teams to do for me. I want them to be working on the right things and to be getting things achieved and done. That's why I'm bringing it up now.

Leadership is partly about setting the standards that you want the people in your team to follow. So if you don't demonstrate working with intent, you cannot expect your team to demonstrate working with intent either. The triangle has three different fundamental ways that you can spend your time as a project manager. You can be proactive, you can start planning and mitigating risks and building up trust and doing all the things that lead to project success. Or you can firefight, you can run between one crisis or problem to the next. Or you can time waste, you can deal with things that don't matter whether they're on the project or even just within the organisation.

Everybody will be doing all three of those things. It's just the proportion of your time that you are spending doing them. Obviously time wasting you would like to minimise, but I doubt anybody can ever really claim to be at zero. The big thing though is the difference between being proactive and firefighting. The more proactive you are, the less likely you will be firefighting. But that is not to say that the people who are firefighting as project managers are bad because they didn't plan properly. Things go wrong in projects all the time, do not feel bad if you are firefighting. But you don't want your team to see you constantly firefighting, they will learn that until the project manager's hair is on fire that they don't have to deliver things, and that is not what you want your project team to be doing, obviously. You want to try and demonstrate proactiveness, or proactivity, to your project team, so that they can pick up on that queue and work to that kind of standard.



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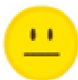
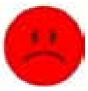
 Name

 Name

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 5 - Micro Lecture 2
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Managing Conflict
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	11/04/22

Content

Conflict management. Healthy conflict will make a project more likely to succeed. Having no conflict at all would rob a project of opportunities to find optimal solutions. But unhealthy conflict corrodes team productivity, their morale, and perhaps even the integrity of some of them. Which in turn will threaten your project timeline and reduce the business case. And if a project is important enough within organisation, then unhealthy conflict can either endanger the organisational survival itself.

This process diagram is from a book called managing conflicts in projects, and it's referred to by the APM directly. It's a process diagram that works just as well for conflicts in your personal life, just as much as working in a project.

Firstly, you take a step back. You focus on the upcoming process. Identify and define what the conflict actually is. And then you seek to understand it, you explore the conflict across some different dimensions:
The subject. What is the conflict?
The parties. Who's involved
The decision criteria. What are both parties trying to achieve?

That then goes through to facilitation where you start to talk to the different parties. Maybe you are one of those parties, or maybe you are a separate facilitator.

And then you address the issue, but to address the issue, you lean back into the negotiation that we have previously talked about. You look at the different parties under conflict and you look at their BATNA and their ZOPA. Refer back to previous lesson if you've forgotten what those are.

You attempt to solve the problem that way. And then you close it with something that's formally recorded to stop it coming back. And maybe that last step is more of a business and professional one than something you can do in your personal life. But it's really important within project management to stop conflict or problems from coming back again and again.

Like I just mentioned, this heavily leans into the negotiation that we have already talked about. Negotiation and managing conflict are almost two sides of the same coin, so you've already learned about managing conflict in a way.

Something that you haven't seen previously before though is Kubler Ross. It's a model that tries to show how people experience the emotions when change happens. In fact it actually it started off as being about grief and the grieving process when somebody has died. But it's been expanded since then to cover just any change, because it's almost the same steps.

As you can see from the diagram, first people enter into shock, then they move into denial, frustration, they get depressed, they start experimenting with their new situation, they come to a decision about how they can learn to live with it, and then they're integrated they are living with it.

That is not to say that each of those steps takes the same amount of time. You might find that some people move from shock through denial, frustration, depression, and to experimentation almost instantaneously. If I told you that you aren't allowed to have any ice cream, we've run out. You will very quickly get into the experimenting part unless it was really, really important to you. It's the same process as if I had told you about something far more serious, that properly impacted you. But it's all about the timings that it takes to move from one end to the other.

Project management or leaders in general really, tend to move through that change curve a bit faster than the rest of their team. And that can explain perhaps why leaders are so good at embracing change and finding opportunities in a situation. It does mean though that PM's can get frustrated that they are further ahead than other people within this change curve. And that can be further exacerbated by the fact that the PM or the leaders might know more information than the workers as well, which just exacerbates the problem of how far ahead they are.

So the people in your team may well be further behind on this change curve than you are. They might be still in the earlier stages, which can be quite painful emotions about a particular change.

The other point to mention with this change curve is that it's not linear. People don't necessarily move from the left to the right. They can have things that knock them back and send them backwards to the start again or just back one or two steps even.

The other thing is that nearly everybody will have changes to accept in their lives and their work lives simultaneously. There might be a person that's experiencing this change curve for 10 different things going on in their life. Maybe they are getting divorced. They're dealing with the fact that they're moving to a new location, or they've just started a new job. They're dealing with the fact that the project has suddenly changed its requirements on them. They're dealing with the fact there's a new team member who's just joined. Some of these things are worse than others, but they're all there in the background being worked through the change curve.

The CMI, the Chartered Management Institute, has quite a few publications about conflict and difficult conversations. They would say that a little bit of prep work by a manager is often enough for them to be able to have a much better way of dealing with difficult conversations.

Something very straightforward that they've published are these three tips for managing a difficult conversation. The first to take the bad with the good, and it's not a new idea, I remember a very long time ago being told to sandwich a piece of bad feedback or news in between two good things. And it's exactly the same really. You don't have to sandwich things necessarily, but the CMI would recommend that if you are going to be delivering some bad feedback or news or talking about something hard, make sure that you end the conversation with something positive instead. So that the person at the end is taking away something that isn't so difficult to stomach.

The next is to don't make it personal, and that's kind of obvious really, but in a professional setting you want to stick to facts and objective things. You do not want to make it into personal attacks.

And the last is to offer support and leadership. Highlight areas that are a problem but still talk about what you can do to help the person improve. It's not a blame culture sort of thing. It's all about feedback that helps people to improve. Most people are understanding enough that they are not perfect and that there are things that they could do better. And if you're going to try and help them to improve themselves, they're much more likely to listen to you.

And that can almost be the difference between a manager and a leader. A leader is somebody that they want to follow to improve themselves. A leader is somebody that you want to emulate the behaviour of. A manager is just somebody that tells you what to do.

And lastly, from that same CMI article in fact, they point out that some of the UK's most difficult conversations happen in the workplace. They are with managers, they are with project managers perhaps. Look at that top ten list and the first four are all workplace related. That's what nearly a third of the people that they surveyed said were tricky conversations. #3 ‘feedback on poor performance’ is the obvious one that a project manager is going to have to try and talk with and deal with. And as I said, making it not personal and trying to constructively give feedback that helps people to move on, perhaps supporting them with training opportunities or extra time, is probably the best way forward.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 6 - Micro Lecture 2
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Team Development
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	11/04/22

Content

In a way this is going to be playing a bit of catch up with the APM. We've already discussed a lot of the concepts in a lot more detail already, even as far back as lesson one, but I think it's important to come round full circle to just tell you what the APM thinks about team development.

So the APM says that projects rely on teams working together effectively and that teams can be made up of lots of different people and personalities and cultures, and they can be all co-located or they can all be separate remote working virtually. Project managers have to pay attention to the team development that happens to create a positive working culture that will enable a high performing team. That involves being clear about goals and objectives, enabling differences to be aired constructively, providing clear roles and responsibilities, promoting honesty and openness, and ensuring that team members are transitioned back into the business when the project has finished.

None of that will sound news to you, I'm sure. The APM will go on to say that you have to make sure that team members understand the roles that they're going to play and who is naturally best suited to certain roles within a team. Again, nothing new necessarily there, think back to Belbin.

The APM would highlight that one way that a project professional can provide variety within a role is to look at what tasks are process and what tasks are technical, and to make sure that they're giving a nice range to the different team members. That if you've got one team member whose role is much more technical to at least give them a stretch and give them something new and interesting to do with a little bit of process work, to help guide and develop them in their CV if nothing else.

But that's enough about the APM. I don't think there's anything brand new there for you. There's also nothing brand new in showing you these two again. You hopefully remember that you had the Tuckman and Hackman models of team development and they're the two models of choice that the APM recommends.

Now for something a bit different, although it's still very much on the theme of team development. Let's talk about some of the bad habits that project managers and leaders can exhibit. Also have a think about how somebody leading you, if they had these bad habits how would that make you feel?

The first is being afraid to delegate, and that is a bit strange for a project manager at first, because we spend most of our work life delegating, PM's don't actually get the work done for themselves. But if you do find that you're picking up tasks from team members because you just think you can do it quicker, you needs to stop, you need to be able to delegate. The root cause of that kind of problem is most normally a lack of trust, and it becomes very apparent very quickly to the team members that you don't trust them and that can lead to all sorts of frustrations and problems.

But when you do delegate, you do not want to micromanage either. When you micromanage a team member and you start asking for a lot of updates, or you start trying to make all the decisions for them. You ultimately get to that stage point of the being afraid delegate part, you eventually lead to the same frustrations and you show the same lack of trust ultimately.

Communication. You must communicate with your team. We've talked previously about levels of transparency and that you might not want to tell them literally everything that is happening, but you have to have good open communications channels. You want your team to be able to come and tell you things as well, obviously. Lack of communication and the bad habits can also apply to the style and type of communication that you are selecting. You don't want to be delivering important news via text message or WhatsApp, and equally you don't want to be calling big formal meetings for trivial matters.

The next is a lack of recognition. Everyone wants to know that they are doing a good job and that their contributions count. And maybe it's just a British thing, but that actually comes quite unnaturally and it's quite hard to do sometimes. Just congratulating people and saying thank you is often enough, but it's often surprising when you look back how little that actually happens.

A lack of accountability. We've talked plenty about making sure that roles and responsibilities are set out, but you want to demonstrate your own accountability as a project manager. If you aren't being seen as being accountable and taking things on from senior management, whether it's good or bad feedback, then the team beneath you will start to wonder why they should bother being accountable when the PM seems to be made of Teflon and nothing ever sticks.

And lastly, disorganised meetings. A huge source of frustration. You want to be modelling the behaviour you want to see in your team, so if you can't set a meeting that runs smoothly with a good agenda that doesn't overrun and start to turn into waffle. Then why should your team be any better?

Of course, not all teams are perfect. And PM's don't always get to start at the beginning with a team. A lot of the time you will walk in to project manage a team that already exists. What I'm about to tell you about, very briefly, is perhaps the worst scenario. What I would call a saboteur team. That would be where members of the team are constantly complaining about each other. They're watching their backs all at the time, just as much as they are doing work. There's lots of things going on behind the scenes, they're undermining, sabotaging, one another. Everybody is suspicious. There's lots of personal agendas, everyone’s got a grudge against somebody else. They all avoid working together, team meetings or the worst thing in the world, everybody dreads talking to one another. And the team mates would all be perfectly happy to see each other fail, they'd be quite happy to see somebody fail and they criticise and they point out their faults all the time.

That's the worst case, and when that happens obviously morale will suffer. The good people will quit. Candidates won't want to join the team, it's got a terrible reputation. There won't be any innovation and risk taking. Your project is very unlikely to work if you walk into a team like that. I'm not sure that you can turn it around quickly or at all necessarily, but what I've just described is the very worst case scenario. However, let's talk about what happens when you do walk into a team.

When you take on an existing team, they're hopefully not that saboteur type that I've just talked about, but you probably will have to take on existing teams and they might not be perfect. Normally, if you do a really good job at something at work, you will then be given a harder job next and that harder job could often be turning around a project that's not going very well. The team won't be the only reason necessarily, but a lot of the time the team not being as good as it could be is a major contributor to a project not going so well.

So what should you? Well, don't do anything big immediately. Don't blast in and on day one start changing everything and making ultimatums. You're not going to win friends and influence team members like that.

Consider a new leader ‘getting to know you’ type process. Remember Tuckman, they will go back to storming. Take some time to understand what's going on with that team. Talk to them all one to one.

By doing so, you'll start to understand the dynamics within the team. Obviously not just through one to ones, you'll have to watch as well. But getting to know all the different people. who they are, how they work, is going to be important. Think of Belbin.

Then work to build some trust through vulnerability. Trust, like we've talked about, is the foundation of lots of different productive relationships. And it is a challenge and it will take time to develop, you can't immediately make it happen on day two or three, it will build up slowly. The best thing that you can do in that situation as a new leader is just show that you're available, show that you're actively engaged and interested. Ask questions. Ask stupid questions, show your vulnerability. Half way through the meeting say “I've lost complete track of this, what's going on again?” That doesn't show that you're stupid, it shows that you are willing to put yourself out there and for the team members to put some trust back into you, and vice versa.

Not necessarily next, but another thing to do is to determine what type of team you really need.
It is very easy to think that the team that you are leading needs to be the best in the world but they don't, they need to be the best for the job at hand. So the particular project that you are running is going to be a big part of that. This isn't the module where we talk about methodologies and how to select one and what you should do, you've done all that before. But choosing the right kind of methodology and making sure that that's the kind of team that you've got is really important.
For example, think of a relay race versus a football team. They are very different sorts of people that do those two different sports. If you need a team that passed tasks from one another, like a relay race, you could argue waterfall, then that's fine. Accept that's what kind of team you need.
Or maybe you need a football or a rugby type team where everybody is constantly interacting with one another to achieve the grander strategy, and maybe that's more agile, I'm not sure, but knowing what type is really important.

And then clearly link the team activities, their tasks which feed into the project, show them how that feeds into the organisational strategy. That is possibly one of the best ways to motivate people, to show that what they're doing really matters and why everybody cares.

Educate and train the team. Obviously you can't do that immediately, but it's a longer term goal.

Recognise the behaviours in the team that help your vision. And equally recognise the ones that do not and then be prepared to make some difficult decisions. When you take on an existing team it doesn't mean that 100% of that team are going to end up working for you. You might need to have some difficult conversations with them or their functional managers.

And the last one which dips into the next topic actually of workplace stress. But it's to develop your own support network. A lot of times leaders will spend so much time and energy focused on other people that they forget to take care of themselves. So find yourself a support system. Maybe that's your project sponsor, or maybe you don't have that type of relationship, in which case it's more of a mentor that is somebody outside of the project. But making sure that you give yourself time to decompress, understand what's going on and be calmer is going to be for the benefit of everybody ultimately.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 6 - Micro Lecture 3
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Workplace Stress
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	11/04/22

Content

Projects can be quite stressful environments to work in. You've got all the different factors associated with the project to manage: time, cost quality, scope, risk, all the others. And that can put a lot of pressure and therefore stress upon you as a project manager, but also a lot of pressure and stress on the team that works for you. I often found when leading teams that I was very careful to not give them too much stress during their work life because it would bleed over into their personal life and they would start to suffer, and therefore become less productive within the team. Ethically, I don't think it's good to place too much stress on your team members, but from a more selfish viewpoint it's also not good to place too much stress on your team members.

The UK Health and Safety Executive defines workplace stress as the adverse diverse reaction that people have to excessive pressure or other types of demand placed upon them. Obviously at work everybody will have pressure and demands placed upon them, but it's how bad those demands are and whether you have a negative reaction to them, that negative reaction is the stress.

Projects are, by their very definition, high pressure environments. You and your team will have specific objectives to deliver on time. to cost and to quality. Some people will find that really motivating and enjoyable, they’ll thrive on the variety and uncertainty that project work entails, other people will not. But even the people that do enjoy it may still find themselves under too much pressure at some points.

The APM defines the situations that can give people too much pressure as these. If someone has a feeling that they have very little control of a situation, pressure. Volume of work to complete at a particular date and time, pressure again. The relationships with other people in the team or stakeholders, or the wider culture of the organisation clashing with what they feel is right to do. And of course their commitments outside of work. Remember that people will sometimes change what they find stressful or not. If they have other things going on at work or in their personal lives, their tolerance for stress might become lower, or higher perhaps.

It's important to think of your own workplace stress as a project manager and the team stress for the people working for you. I can think of lots of times as a PM where I had perception of having very little control of a situation. You were left to the mercy and whims of your senior stakeholders or the budget holders as to what was going to happen next. Your fate wasn't always completely within your own hands.

So that's the APM project management look at stress. I think it's quite interesting as well to look at a much wider definition of stress. This is from MIND a UK based charity that deals with stress. It's not business specifically, it's not even workplace specifically, it's just for everybody. I've highlighted the yellow parts which actually match up very very well with the APM. So feeling under lots of pressure, not having control, having responsibilities that are you find overwhelming or just going through a period of uncertainty. And it's that last yellow one that I really quite like in a in a sadistic way because it is almost the definition of projects. You are signing up by being a project manager to constantly be in a period of uncertainty, that's your speciality in your work.

You might be wondering why I've put a Gantt chart up on the screen and it's not just because I'm from an Agile background and they stress me out. My point here is about contingency.

Project managers combine their knowledge of the team and the work schedule so that they can manage the level of work and expectations around pressured time periods of delivery. They have to build in contingency to be able to face those problems, to face and react to problems that come up in terms of things taking longer than expected or just the uncertainty that is always going to be there in projects. But there's one thing within business, and it creeps into project management, which really gets in the way of having a sensible amount of contingency. And it's called JIT, just in time.

Just in time is really a manufacturing term and it's from lean, it's also a supply chain term. What just in time is is that for this supply chain, for example, you don't want to have lots of inventory stored in the warehouse. You don't want to be building your product and then storing it for six months before you sell it. You ideally want to be building your product and it immediately goes on a lorry to the customer and you don't have to worry about storing it at all. And equally all the things that you put in your product, you don't want to be storing them, you want them to arrive the day that you need them. That's really efficient and great in operations and supply chain and manufacturing.

But in project management, if you are delivering everything at the last minute, you've effectively made everything in your project the critical part. The Gantt chart on the screen is only a 10 step project, it's got 10 tasks and about half of them are critical path. You're more likely to have something as it has a few 100 or maybe 1000 tasks in a normal sized project. If half of those were on the critical path, you would be an incredibly stressed out project manager. You would be spending much of your, relatively short, experience at that organisation constantly giving updates about the schedule slipping because you wouldn't have enough slack in your schedule to deal with problems when they arose. So adopting the just in time mentality of every task being delivered just as it's needed will be a scenario where you cannot possibly succeed.

And it will also mean that your team is going to be extremely stressed. Instead of having a nice relatively flat demand upon all the people in your project, you are going to have massive peaks and troughs of activity and inactivity which is going to stress them out.

I've seen some organisations set KPIs on project managers to make sure that they only have a critical path with a number of tasks that's less than X percent of the overall project, and I advise and agree with that kind of statement. It's good to have a critical path that is not too much of your project. Of course, setting a KPI like that doesn't take account of the fact that different tasks or different sizes, you can always go and break API and game the system.

So if anybody ever tells you to speed up your project without removing any of the scope, then feel free to point out that that's going to put more things on the critical path and it will lead to more workplace stress for your team. The type of person that makes that demand of you is probably not going to be convinced by that argument, but it will allow you to at least say I told you so later.

This model is admittedly ancient, Yerkes Dodson in 1908, but it is still useful. Their point was that you have a certain level of stress which is the best to be. You don't want no stress because at that point you are bored, you're on the left hand side of that chart. Equally, even 100 years ago, more than 100 years ago, they still didn't think having too much stress was a good idea, but there's an optimum level.

That optimum level will be different for individuals, no one person is going to have exactly the same tolerance to stress and pressure. But also, people can build up their personal resilience over time. Think about back to when you were much younger and just starting in the world of work. Today you would probably find doing that level of work much more comfortable than you did back then. Your personal resilience will have grown. You might even be bored doing that old job now.

For a team on a project that is still going to be true. You're obviously not going to have 10-20 years with the same people on the project team, but even month to month you will find that people start to tolerate higher levels of stress. That's not to advocate that we want to ramp it up so that everybody can work under extreme stress and pressure. But it does mean that you can remember that fact and not be too scared of sometimes placing some stress on your team. Make sure though that they understand that you are also experiencing that stress. You do not want to be the project manager that is very laid back while the team runs around like headless chickens.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 7 - Micro Lecture 1
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Diversity & Inclusion
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	12/04/22

Content

There are many different traits or characteristics that an individual might have, and that individual might be on your project team or work within your organisation. Everybody is a little bit different, and that's what diversity is.

In the UK there are laws around certain characteristics. The Equality Act protects certain characteristics to make it illegal to discriminate against people because of that particular characteristic. However, I don't really want to get too much into the legal side of things here, because whether a characteristic is protected or not, it's still a source of diversity that you probably will experience in working with other people in project teams.

The things that can lead to diversity and make people different might be their nationality, their cultural background, their race, age, gender, gender identification, their physical appearance, disability, sexuality, their relationship status, their marriage status, religion, whether they're a parent, educational background, and even just their personality.

It's quite possible that you could have somebody in a project team that ticks off lots of those bullet points. It's not just one, it's a big mix and at that point there's a lot of different combinations, an infinite number of combinations to be honest.

So for the rest of this micro lecture, let's consider nationalities and cultural backgrounds. Just because it's perhaps a little bit less problematic, and I'm less likely to put my foot into something by accident.

National cultures have been developed over centuries with influences like religion, wars and geographic location all having an effect in building strong values and intrinsic beliefs about how to behave. These are influential in shaping people's behaviours. And so when you're working within a project, you might need to understand those behaviours. Externally you might have a stakeholder group, or maybe even it's your customer, that is from a certain national culture and at that point it would be useful to have at least a small understanding of that culture, so that you can get into the mindset of your customer or stakeholder.

But internally as well, you might have people on your project team who are from a different national culture and it would be useful to understand their belief system and where they are coming from as well. So as part of a stakeholder analysis, you might research the drivers that underpin the national culture, to gain clues about the typical behaviours within that culture. That way when you go and tell your customer something in a certain way, you will at least have an idea of how they might react and therefore you can deliver your message in a particular way that hopefully will get you the best result.

When I had meetings with new companies in a different country, I'd try and do some quick research on their national identity. Googling, 'working with country culture' will give you thousands of results when you just wanted something quick. That's why the Cultural Atlas which you'll see within the lesson coming up is a relatively good source. It's written from an Australian viewpoint and it's to explain the cultural backgrounds of Australia's migrant communities. So it's not perfect, but it does go into enough detail, brief detail, but you can spend 5-10 minutes getting at least an overview of a national identity and culture. For some reason it unfortunately does not include every single country of the world. There are a few African nations and Caribbean nations and a few Eastern European countries that aren't covered by the Cultural Atlas.

But using cultural descriptions is a very easy way to just fall in stereotyping the entire population of a country with sweeping statements. All French people wear striped T shirts, and carry around baguettes, all English people have a break at 10:00 o'clock for tea, all Spanish people have siestas in the afternoon. I'll ask you to try an activity coming up to demonstrate some of that kind of stereotyping and how to avoid it, ultimately. But it also doesn't take account of regional or city based differences. You'll probably agree that there are differences between some aspects of culture between people who live in London versus Manchester, or Paris versus the rest of France. And then there's also that people from the same country, or even city, can have different backgrounds, experiences, religions, beliefs, personalities, lots of changes. You cannot just rely on a single identifier. You have to take account of the wider person. What I'm really trying to get at is that this might be a useful shorthand just to get started so that you've got an idea when you first enter the room, but none of this is really a substitute for getting to know an individual person at an individual level.

Embracing diversity sounds like a good thing to do. The opposite, treating people differently because of a particular trait absolutely sounds like an appalling thing to do. But on top of the moral aspect of being inclusive, there is sound evidence that diverse project teams create better performance. People from different backgrounds and cultures will have different experiences and perspectives that they can bring to a team or to a problem. You'll have better problem solving and better ideas within a project team. As a project manager, you should try to harness this diversity to improve your project outcomes.

Unfortunately, human nature can often lead to us favouring people that are like ourselves rather than different from us, and this can happen without a person realising that they're even doing it. It can be hard to realise or accept that a person has these unconscious biases. The best way to identify them is through experience and challenging your own thinking. Awareness of unconscious biases is the first step to addressing them. There is however lots of debate, some of it wrapped up in politics, around whether unconscious bias training is worthwhile, or whether it actually works in stopping discrimination. Whether that debate will ever really conclude is itself debatable, but there's an activity coming up to let you try it for yourself so that you can draw your own conclusions.

That's it, really. I don't want to lecture you about diversity, in the bad sense of the word where I tell you what to do. You're dealt the hand that you're given with project teams. You don't often get to choose who's going to be on there, so you can't force diversity to happen necessarily. But wherever it does, you should definitely embrace it, not just because it's the right thing to do, but also because it will give you better outcomes on your project.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 7 - Micro Lecture 2
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Myers Briggs Type Indicator
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	12/04/22

Content

The Myers Briggs Type Indicator, or MBTI, is based upon the conceptual framework proposed by the Swiss psychiatrist Carl Jung. Jung had speculated that people experience the world using four principal psychological functions; sensation, intuition, feeling and thinking, and that one of these four functions is dominant for a person most of the time. So within MBTI there are four categories and you are either A or B for each category, and those are:
Introversion and extraversion
Sensing and intuition
Thinking and feeling
Judging and perceiving

Each person is set to have one of those preferred qualities from each category. And that produces 16 different unique combinations which are therefore 16 different personalities in MBTI.

This diagram sums up MBTI and it's 16 different personality types, and I'm not going to try and talk you through each of the 16 one by one. After this micro lecture you'll do a quiz and you will read through far more detailed information than I'd want to try and talk through in a micro lecture. But let's talk through the four different characteristics, where you can be one side of a coin on each, and then that's why there are so many different combinations that lead to 16 different types.

So the first is extroversion or introversion. Extroverts are talkative, outgoing, they like to be in a fast paced environment and they enjoy being the centre of attention. Whereas introverts are far more reserved and private, they prefer to be by themselves, figure things through at a slightly slower pace, and they would rather be on the outside than the centre of attention. It's probably quite. Easy for you to pick which of those two you might be.

The next is sensing versus intuition. That's all about how you take information in. So people who come out as sensing, they focus on the here and now, they're much more practical, they like to describe things in a very specific way. Intuition is somebody that's a bit more thinking of the big picture, they enjoy ideas and concepts for their own sake, rather than just how they might be practical or not. They're a lot more imaginative in how they might want to describe things, they might use metaphors and similes rather than wanting very specific, detailed information.

The next is thinking versus feeling. So that's how you prefer to make your decisions. People who come out as thinkers would want to use an impersonal, very logic driven way for making their decisions. They would appreciate justice, fairness, what the rules are and they'd enjoy finding the flaws in an arguement. People who come out as feeling are going to care far more about the people side. They'll have their personal values and that's how they start to make their decisions. They will value harmony and forgiveness within the rest of the team, whereas a thinker would not. They want to try and find the best in people to come to a decision and they would be described as warm and empathetic, whereas perhaps a thinker might be described as more robotic.

And the fourth one is judging versus perceiving. So people who come out as judging, they prefer to have matters settled. They have rules and deadlines and think that they are important and should be respected. They like to have detailed step by step instructions or plan. Whereas perceiving is a lot more free flowing and going. They would prefer to leave options open. They wouldn't see rules and deadlines as quite so concrete, they would be more flexible. And they would enjoy improvising and being spontaneous.

You can be any combination of all of those four different characteristics, and that's why there are 16 different personality types.

I would not want you to take any of the models, but I tell you about as gospel during this module, but in particular I think it's worth coming out with some of the criticisms that exist of MBTI because there are numerous criticisms. Most importantly perhaps, psychologists in general do not regard MBTI as being very accurate. They liken it to horoscopes or a fortune cookie. They would point out that MBTI statements around the different types of personality are very Barnum-esque. A Barnum statement is one which is strategically vague, it does not give very much substance whatsoever, but is written with just enough ambiguity so that people can read into it and conclude that it describes them.

Also the other perhaps more academically thorough argument which isn't just stone throwing, is that of the 16 personalities in MBTI none are bad. Nobody will complete the quiz and get a personality type where they do not like it. There are very few negative statements describing any of the personalities. So if Myers Briggs appears to describe you well, it's because it's constructed to do so, these critics would argue, it's because you want to read yourself into it. It tactfully stays away from what psychologists would term a fifth characteristic, which is neuroticism, as in how introverted you are in your thinking and how much worrying you do because of that neuroticism. But also they would say it's because you already partially want to believe in the statements that you are reading, confirmation bias will entrench your belief into that personality type.

So after that last slide of rather scathing criticism of MBTI, I'm still going to suggest in a minute that you go and do a test. Whether MBTI has as much validity as reading tea leaves or horoscopes or not is almost sort of irrelevant. There's lots of businesses that use MBTI, or a simplified version of it, in the hiring process or in team building. There's also an increasing number of people, perhaps some of them are on your project team, who subscribe to Myers Briggs and they identify themselves with one of the 16 types. Once they've done that, they start to play up to the traits that that personality type is supposed to exhibit, whether it's real or not.

Do you remember from the last lesson for Ted talk on humour in projects? Where the project manager presenting said that one of the team was an Ewok. Yeah, it was a geeky Star Wars reference and you can go and find online lots of different pictures of MBTI versus different fictional movie characters and franchises. But what that project manager was doing was giving his team and MBTI test. And it assigned different personality types to different people in the team and it brought them together and gave them something to start to talk about to try and understand each other with. And it's perhaps the team understanding each other, regardless of whether the model is real or not, that is the important part to do.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 8 - Micro Lecture 1
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Talent Management
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	12/05/22

Content

When discussing talent management it's very easy to slip up and start to talk about human resources, HR, and at that point you'll start thinking to yourself, "I'm not a HR manager, I don't want to be a HR manager, I want to be a project manager, why am I learning this and discussing talent management?" Firstly, I'm going to try and stick to the project management view of the topic, partly because that's the only viewpoint I have direct industry experience of, but also because that's what the APM thinks that you need to know to be a project manager.

Second, though I've used this picture before in some of your lessons in the course and you might have seen it elsewhere too, it's actually the 3rd result on Google images when you search for Project Manager. Project managers are jacks of all trades, we dabble in nearly every area of a business and therefore we need to know enough to be effective. That's why you need to know about talent management.

Talent management is about effectively exploiting and developing the knowledge of people by investing in the organisations core competencies and building capability through effective talent planning and resourcing strategies. That is the HR and also the project management, definition of talent management. But what are the benefits of managing talent?

It would be these. Let's consider them firstly from a top level business, or even a functional manager, point of view. By managing the talent in your organisation different people will gain skills, knowledge and work practices. You'll encourage wider relationships as people will work with one another more, which also encourages cross functional working. Because people see more areas and see more people, they'll get a better overall awareness of the business and its operations. It'll support their continuous improvement and development by keeping them interested and motivated. The people who've just required new skill sets or knowledge will take it back to their function or a different role and it will spread that knowledge out. It'll enable you to have better succession planning. And it will give your organisation overall greater capability from its workforce.

And I can't argue with any of those things, they're great, from a business top level point of view. If I was a very short term selfish project manager though, not many of those things will actually help me. In fact, some of them might even hinder me because people will be coming in and out of my team to go and acquire new skill sets or strengthen wider relationships. And that's great for the overall business, but for a short term project manager like me that doesn't help. Of course you don't want to be just the short term selfish project manager, there need to be a little bit of that within you perhaps, but you also want to take a medium and long term view of the overall organisation getting better. Even if that's not directly what you're being tasked with and measured against.

You can see here the APM view on talent management. I think the APM takes a slightly different viewpoint, it's not off the top level organisation or of a functional manager. Instead the APM takes their viewpoint of a project manager, which isn't surprising I suppose, but it's all about the talent management of project management talent rather than general talent throughout an organisation.

It's not dissimilar to the last slide I showed you, but taking the viewpoint of being a project manager, yourself perhaps who wants to have your talent managed by experiencing different things. being rewarded, being trained properly, ,aking sure that your talents are recognised. It is a different viewpoint certainly. So you have to exist within a talent management structure and be managed yourself, but you also need to consider the talent management of the people working within your project team.

There's a book I ask you to read a chapter of in this lesson, and it's called 'winning the war for talent'. Within that book tt breaks down talent management into these sections. As you can see, nearly all of it is about recruiting candidates, and whilst project managers might get involved with interviewing people from time to time, you are not the recruiter for your team. So I'm not going to focus on that part, instead I'm going to focus on the very last bullet point there that the book identifies, which is retaining employees.

Retaining employees is broken into this pyramid, within 'winning the war for talent'. There's a bottom layer which is recruitment in the first place. If you recruit bad people all of this stuf falls down because the foundation isn't solid, but let's assume that you've hired some reasonable people to start with. This is then what you would do to retain them. The book is taking an organisational level, but let's discuss where a project manager in their day to day experience can add in or do something which impacts any of these different levels.

The first is 1to1s. This is probably the most straightforward for a project manager to do, it's most within your control. Holding the regular one to one with the people within your team is a really easy but important thing to do. In the same way that you want your manager to take an interest in what you're doing and help you and let you share your experiences, the people working within your team for you also want to have that opportunity with yourself. So holding a regular, or at least semi regular, one to one meeting with each of your team members is really important. Depending on the size of your team, you might want to delegate that down to different junior project managers perhaps. You can't have one to ones with 100 people every month obviously.

But what you do want to make sure you're doing is not exhibiting any favouritism. If you have a one to one with one person every month, and the other one you're always ignoring, that other person is not going to be very loyal to you or be very effective.

Another hint on one to ones is never cancel somebodies. Put them in your calendar as a recurring meeting and without fail do not cancel them. If the other person wants to cancel it, let them. It is their time to have a one to one with you, but you would never want to cancel it and give an impression that you don't care.

One to ones are also not the same as personal development meetings. It is not the place to give feedback. You want to give feedback for good or bad work pretty much immediately when it happens, and then you want to revisit it within a professional development review or mention it to the functional manager that does that. But one to ones are the place to receive feedback. If somebody has some feedback or good or bad about what you are doing, you want to listen to that.

It is very slippery and difficult ground for a project manager to get too involved in rewards and recognition for the people in their team. At the very most you want to do very gentle lobbying to the functional manager that probably has that responsibility, in a matrix organisation which is what you most likely work in.

You want to champion the people that work for you. If they've done a great job, you want to tell as many people as possible, but you really can't get that involved with salary negotiations. If you have a team member coming to you saying that they don't feel that they are paid enough. There's very little that you can directly do about that. And be honest and share that with them during a one to one.

One thing you can do however is recognition. It's not quite the same as a monetary reward, but recognition. There is nothing necessarily that stops you from having things like a Hall of Fame or team member of the month or rewarding with recognition a really good job well done. You want to be careful you're not displaying favouritism and you're not leaving anybody out but having some kind of small monthly prize. Or maybe there's a wider organisational Hall of Fame, for example with lots of plaques of names on the wall that you can get involved with for your team.

One thing that I have seen and would not recommend doing is the anti version of a Hall of Fame type recognition. I've seen the 'Golden Calculator' award handed out to the person that made for worst calculation mistake during the month and then it sits on thier desk. And everybody laughs and it's fun, but I'm still not completely sure that that's the right message to be sending to people. I'm not sure that the recipient of the Golden calculator actually was that happy really.

Sticking with the topic of rewards and recognition. One thing you can get involved with as a PM are objectives and KPI (key performance indicator) settings. These are the objectives for an individual will have discussed at their personal development review and ultimately achieving these objectives will link to their salary progression or bonuses. And you can get involved with that process very easily, in fact you should be.

There are two different types of objectives that you can set SMART and MAGIC. Smart is probably more well known if I'm honest, but I actually prefer magic. There are of course though plenty of overlaps.

An objective needs to be measurable, which goes without saying really, that's within smart and magic.

They need to be achievable, which is also there in both. But if you give somebody an impossible stretch target, even if it's got a great bonus applied to it for that superhuman effort to reach the impossible, it's unlikely that they're going to be that motivated. Giving them something much smaller and more achievable, even if it's less glorious at the end with a bonus, is much better.

They need to be goal oriented. Ideally all of the objectives that go up the chain of command or hierarchy within a business should be linked together. The people in the team should be having objectives which help their manager. That manager should then have objectives that go up the chain, that overall help the business.

They need to be individual. That's a trap that we often fall into in project management, giving a whole team an objective to reach often means that it will be difficult to give proper accountability. People will not feel in control of their objective and if it goes wrong, it's very easy for them to not be accountable for what went wrong either, because there's too many people involved. So you need to make sure that you have individual goals given to an individual.

And lastly, clear and simple. You do not want a subjective objective being given to you, because who knows if you're going to meet it or not, it shouldn't be at the whim of your manager to decide whether you've met your objective or not. It should be straightforward and clear to see if you have or haven't.

KPIs, whether they're smart or magic, work best if you've got about 3 at the very most for a person. Anymore than that and it dilutes their focus and consequently dilutes the outcomes. However, objectives shouldn't last forever, you wouldn't want to have the same 3 objectives for two years. Ideally, objectives should come and go after a few months so that you're constantly having new objectives that meet the new demands of the business or the project.

And lastly, as a PM, it's always good to go and talk to the existing employees for their input. You might not be in charge of all three of their objectives, it might just be one project objective, but talk to them. Get them to help set what that objective is, because then they'll have more ownership of it and it will build trust as well.

Next on the pyramid for retaining people is high impact learning and development. As a project manager, you can train people in project management I suppose, but the people on your team are not project managers they are subject matter experts in other things. They don't necessarily want to learn to be a PM, although sometimes you do have that person that would like to branch out into PM, then you can help support them. Your main role here as a PM though is just to support peoples requests for training.

You might identify those yourself because your project needs a certain skill. It's not available in the organisation and you need to upskill somebody and it may as well be in your team. But you might also just have team members that come to you saying that they'd like some training in something, and ideally you should support those requests to functional management or whoever is actually responsible for them. Again though, being careful not to step on other people's toes in the world of a functional manager.

You retain people through good communication, which is relatively obvious. It stretches from the organisation sharing its business goals with all the people, down to you in your project making sure that you share the project goals with your team. A large part of this though is also just making sure that there's open and transparent communication between everybody within your project team. People will feel much happier and be more likely to stick around if that's the case.

Next on the pyramid was team planning. This is a hard one for a project manager to be involved with. You have a project team and you're obviously trying to make sure that that team is managed and there's a plan for what people are doing. But the concept of the project manager getting involved with selecting who is going to be on the team or come into the team is fraught with politics and danger of stepping on the toes of a functional manager in a matrix organisation.

You should understand the succession planning. You should know if one person is going to leave your team, is there a plan for how they would be replaced? Or would it be that recruitment will start on the day they leave and you'll have a three month gap and you'll need to just cope. But you're not the person doing the succession planning ideally. There isn't always space on your project for you to be doing that kind of work, but it's also normally resting with other people in the business. You should though highlight to functional management, even if it's quite awkward, if you think that there are people who are flight risks of leaving the business, or if there's really key people that if they leave you will need to have a plan for how they are succeeded.

You possibly might care far more than the functional manager does. You will care because it will impact your project, whereas the functional manager is just losing one of twenty people in their team and they'll get a replacement eventually.

And the last on the pyramid was perks. As a project manager, you're not going to be able to get involved with the organisational employee perks that happen. Things like discounted gym membership, dental insurance, levels of maternity and paternity leave. They're not your realm and you can't get involved with those, and I don't think you'd want to try either.

But perks at a project level are still possible. Tiny little things count. Small gestures like bringing along biscuits for a meeting, buying somebody a coffee, paying for the first round of drinks if the team goes out after work, they're all quite small, but they really do count. You will find though, that in doing those things you're building individual relationships between yourself and a team member or yourself and the whole team. You're not building a relationship between a team member and the organisation at that point.

And that might seem obvious if you're the person buying them a coffee, but even if you are following the more formal organisational rewards and perks that are available, say there's a nomination scheme where you can put people forward to get a voucher for Amazon for £20 or something. Even then you're still building the relationship between yourself as the nominator and the person you've nominated, it's still not all about the organisation.

The one time it does count more towards the organisation is where it's very obviously the organisation paying. As project manager, you might have a budget for trying to develop and motivate your team, and if you don't I would potentially recommend asking the sponsor for a small budget to do that. Being able to pay for an awayday or just a Friday afternoon fun activity with the team for team building purposes. Where it's obviously paid for by the company because you wouldn't spend a few £100 pounds taking the team to paintballing or an escape room or whatever it is. This does help build up that organisational link. It does, however, lead to jealousy between different project teams, because there might be a fun one and the one that doesn't do anything. But in a way that isn't your problem, you're the project manager not the business owner.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 9 - Micro Lecture 1
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Regulations
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	12/05/22

Content

I fully admit that this is not going to be the most interesting micro lecture that you have on this module or on your MSc, but it's still important stuff. Hopefully this micro lecture will let you make some notes which form the basis of a project management 'cheat sheet' for regulations.

Everything I'm about to talk about is based on UK regulations, often backed up by legislation, i.e., laws, but you will find similar, if not identical, regulations and laws in most other countries too. And even if not, you should perhaps consider these as a best practise to adopt. A lot of what you're about to see, you will have training courses on at any company that you likely work at. Organisations have to prove that their workforce is aware and has been trained in most of these different regulations. So I'm going to give you a brief overview anyway, but then I'm going to try and pepper it with my own experiences as a project manager, to tell you things that might impact you day to day or the rare one off events.

GDPR, it stands for General Data Protection Regulation. It's an EU law that still applies to the UK and a lot of people throughout the world actually, any organisation that has any footprint in Europe has to abide by GDPR. So there will be American companies processing American peoples data, but because they have a footprint in the EU this still applies. It specifies how personal data should be processed, that means how it's collected, used, protected or interacted with. It's intended to strengthen data protection for all the people whose personal information falls within its scope. It puts personal data control back into the hands of the individual.

So what's data? Well, data is any piece of information, even if it's been anonymized or encrypted, which you can identify an individual with. That includes collecting pieces of data together which would allow you to identify the individual. Examples of personal data might include names, health data, genetic data, web data such as IP addresses, email addresses, political opinions, sexual orientation. A lot of things can be personal data. Examples of non personal data would be not about an individual, so that would be things like a company registration number or a generic company email address.

Under GDPR the data can only be processed if there's a legal basis for doing so. And the legal bases are that the user has given consent for one or more specific purposes, and that the data processing is necessary for the performance of some contract in which the user is a participant. That's why on a lot of websites, for instance, you will be clicking a box giving your consent for your data to be stored and processed.

The key point for a project manager here is if you're collecting any kind of data from members of the public, or individuals even if they work at an organisation, but data on the individual person. Then you are probably going to run into GDPR. And if that's the case you will probably have a GDPR controller within your organisation that you need to go and make friends with and understand. Wherever possible, just don't collect data on individual people and then you have avoided GDPR and the pain it will cause you.

The other thing just to tell you about other three terms that are used within GDPR. There's a user, that is the individual whose personal data is being processed. There's the data controller, that's the person or legal entity that is determining the purpose and ways of processing the personal data collected from the user. And then there's the data processor, that's the person or legal entity that's actually processing the personal data on behalf of the controller. For example, you might have an Internet company that collects user information via their website and they store it in a third party cloud service. In that scenario you have; the user who is having the aata collected from them, you have the data controller being the Internet company that's deciding what information they're taking and what they need to do with it, finally you have the third party cloud service, they have a data processor acting on behalf of the data controller.

Anti bribery legislation. It is illegal to offer, promise, give, request, agree, receive or accept a bribe. Organisations have to have policies and procedures in place to try and protect their employees from being asked to make bribes or from requesting bribes. But it's not just about money being passed under a table necessarily. Some of the high risk areas that you might find as a project manager are gifts and hospitality. A supplier giving you a gift, it always runs a fine line between what is an acceptable business gift (and generally an organisation will have a value amount that they place upon what's acceptable) versus something that is a bribe. And that might also have to do with the timing of when the external organisation gives you that gift as well. If you are letting a contract on your project for who's going to be the supplier of something and one of them sends you £100 gift voucher. That is suspicious timing and you really should be wondering about why they've given you that gift and reporting it to the appropriate people in your organisation. It could also be sponsorship, donations or investment into a community to be able to win a contract or make something happen.

Conflicts of interest can also be counted as bribery. Bribery is not necessarily about money exchanging hands, it's other things that people might assign value to. So it could be having a brother perhaps who works within a potential client organisation, somebody that you're targeting as a customer, and the fact that you and your brother would need to step away from any of the commercial discussions that were happening at that point, because you would be sharing information which would not be in the best interests of each individual organisation.

The other one, which is perhaps the most likely to impact on project managers or their teams, are facilitation payments. This would be all about customs, it would be from moving or travelling, either yourself or goods between borders, and you might find that there are corrupt officials, perhaps who request payments to allow something to happen. That would be a facilitation payment.

As a project manager, I never travelled that much outside of the country, but I know lots of supply chain colleagues that regularly travelled all over the world and also had to take either items or prototypes or samples with them, and so therefore had to deal with customs. It wasn't uncommon, I know of a few people who, upon landing after a 8 hour flight to a new country. Came off the plane, got to customs with the things that they were carrying in their luggage or had been in the hold, and they were asked for a payment for some official to be able to stamp off some licence or a piece of paperwork or just skip ahead in the queue to save an hour. That is being asked for a bribe.

And as a UK employee it is illegal for you to pay bribes, full stop really. However, that's much easier to just say now than if it's actually happening to you in an airport somewhere. Therefore the UK government gives some advice as to what to do.

The first piece is maybe the most obvious, but certainly the most important. That is if a demand for some money is being accompanied by a threat to yourself in terms of your life, limb, or liberty. Then just pay the bribe. Make notes about what has happened, tell your organisation, but if it's threatening your safety don't try and resist.

If it's not, then the UK Government would advise you to exercise some negotiation. You're trying to get some written proof of what it is that you're being asked to pay, and written proof that you've been requested to pay it, and then who has received that money? Ask for official documentation, receipts with people's names on it. If none of that is forthcoming, then it is more and more suspicious as being a bribe. The thing that you want to try and avoid is not having any sort of documentation or proof of what has happened. Because at that point you are opening yourself up perhaps to accusations of how you suggested that you were going to give some money to an official to make something happen, rather than it having actually been the other way around. I don't want to scare anybody though, this is quite a rare event and it's much more common to have happened back in the past than it will now, but that's not to say that requests for bribes, particularly at borders, can never happen.

Discrimination. We talked about diversity a few lessons back and how it was a useful and good thing to do just for your own motives as a project manager, regardless of it being the right thing to do. But it is also written into law. The Human Rights Act makes it illegal to discriminate on a wide range of grounds. Those are known as protected characteristics, things which you cannot discriminate about. Those are: age, gender reassignment, being married or in a civil partnership, being pregnant or on maternity leave, disability, race, including colour, nationality, ethnic or national origin, religion or belief, sex and sexual orientation.

You cannot discriminate about any of those protected characteristics. And discrimination can come in. One of the following forms.

You can have direct discrimination which is treating somebody with a protected characteristic less favourably than other people. You can have harassment, unwanted behaviour linked to a protected characteristic that violates somebody dignity or creates an offensive environment for them. And victimisation, treating someone unfairly because they've complained about discrimination or harassment. Those three types of discrimination are quite hard to accidentally do. You have to actively be wanting to discriminate against somebody.

The fourth one though is easier to trip over without careful thought, even if you don't mean to. indirect discrimination, that's putting rules or arrangements in place that apply to everybody, but that puts someone with a protected characteristic at an unfair disadvantage. That can happen in a project, if you are a project manager who is perhaps asking the team to work late one night and you will give them some kind of company treat. You'll buy lots of pizzas and everybody can stay till midnight (I'm not suggesting that's a great idea, but I've seen it happen). Then you're discriminating against some people. What if you've got somebody on your team who is pregnant who can't stay up till midnight? What happens if you've got somebody that needs to pray because of their religion or they need to go visit a church? Those are at that point discriminating against those people. You might not have meant to necessarily, but it is thoughtless, and it counts as indirect discrimination. So when you are making any kind of rules or statements that apply to the entire of your team, be careful that you're not indirectly discriminating against one of them.

Lone working. As an employer, you must manage any health and safety risks before people can work alone. That applies to anybody who's contracted to work for you, even self-employed people who happen to be part of your team as a contractor. I've never worked in the construction industry and obviously on a building site like this picture here, having one person working all by himself is a particularly dangerous and stupid idea.

But it's not just where it's such an obvious case, even in an office based environment, lone working is still a problem. If you are yourself staying late as project manager, or you've got somebody on your team that says they're going to stay late after everybody else has gone home, you need to think about their lone working status. It might not be high risk work like in construction, but there's still a risk. What happens if that individual who is in the office by themself has a heart attack? What happens if they fall over and hurt themselves? There won't be anybody there to help or find them until they reach a phone or until the next morning when people turn up to work. You have to consider lone working.

Normally in a business there will be, either in a large business some kind of security person who will have a a note of who's in the building, in a smaller business, there will be some kind of buddy system or process in place. Where the last two people need to check in on each other, and when one of them wants to go home, the other one has to leave as well.

Interestingly, this directive about lone working still applies to people working from home as well. Employers have the same health and safety responsibilities for home workers as they do for people inside their office.

Next one to briefly tell you about is COSHH, which is the control of substances hazardous to health. And at first that might seem like it only applies in some very specific industries, but actually it applies to any chemical within your business. If you have a cleaning cupboard with some bleach in it, you need to have a COSHH assessment for that bleach. You need to have a small guide, it's just a print out of a sheet, that tells people what it that substance is and what they need to do if they come into contact with that substance. So if they spill it, what's the procedure? If they get it in there eye what do they have to do?

There are some businesses where the COSHH system is a huge database because they'll have hundreds or thousands of chemicals. And that's obviously true of pharmaceuticals, but in any kind of manufacturing as well, for different lubricants and greases that might be involved on the factory line. they will have COSHH assessment. But even a small business with a cleaning cupboard will have to have COSHH.

Health and safety, although really the term is HSE which is Health Safety Environment.
I'm not going to go into lots of different HSE legislation really, but the important things that you might need to be aware of as a project manager is that any accidents or near accidents that happen have to be reported to your organisations HSE representative. They need recording and depending upon the exact details of what's happened. They might have to pass that up to the health and safety executive themselves, so you have to report injuries, diseases, and dangerous occurrences, and that's something called RIDDOR. The RIDDOR organisation take those incident reports and feed them up a chain and that's so that no an industry or nationwide level they can look at particular trends and things they might need to do to make life safer for workers.

Manual handling, something a little bit closer to home maybe? Manual handling actually causes about a third of all workplace injuries, and they can be very short term injuries, but they can be long term as well, like most musculoskeletal disorders, things like back pain.

The term manual handling covers a wide variety of activities, so lifting, lowering, pushing, pulling, and carrying. And if you don't carry those sorts of things out appropriately, you are at risk of injuring yourself. That might seem obvious and you don't want to be told how to pick up a box, but when you're a project manager you do have to think about that. There were lots of times that I can think of where I myself asked one of my team members to just help me move something. We needed to get test equipment ready to take somewhere and put it in the back of a car, or we needed to go and move a prototype down to an office because we had a customer coming in to have a look. My general philosophy for those situations would be to not ask somebody to do something I wasn't willing to do or help do myself. So if I wasn't comfortable carrying the box, I wouldn't be asking one of my team members to do it either, but really that's not good enough when it comes to manual handling.

There are strict definitions and limits on how heavy something is that a single person or a group of people are allowed to try and pick up and carry. Otherwise you need equipment, you might need a forklift truck for example, and then somebody has to be significantly trained on how to use a forklift truck. But the limits are not that high, just because I was comfortable to pick up a 20kg box and take it from one side of an office to another doesn't actually mean that I should have been doing it or asking anybody else to do it either. So be careful when you are asking people to help you lift or move things that you're not actually breaching manual handling rules.

DSE, which stands for display screen equipment. Employers have to protect the health risks of their workers when they're working with display screen equipment, so that is looking at computers and monitors, but also how they're sitting at a desk to look at those monitors. By law, your employer would have to make sure that they're giving you sufficient breaks from looking at the screen. They're giving you a comfortable desk setting that doesn't cause health and physical problems, and they need to go and check with you around that very regularly.

It's quite normal for employees to have a DSE assessment, which is just an online quiz for five minutes, but they have to have that every year so that the employer can show that they are taking DSE seriously. As a project manager, you're not the person who's buying people special chairs or desks, or mousepads with pads in them, but you will have to consider how long you are making people sit and stare at screens potentially.

That might be if you're having an all day workshop whilst you're working from home on the screen, you need to make sure that you're giving people breaks. But even if you are all sat in an office you want to be making sure that people aren't sat staring at their screens for too long. You want to do that because that's what the DSE regulations say about having breaks, but also regardless of laws, you don't want people to be sat staring at screens for that long either, because at that point they're not going to be particularly efficient. People need to have breaks.

We're nearly at the end, I just want to tell you about slips and trips. These can happen for a number of different reasons. And really it's an organisational thing, having a safe workplace. But as a project manager you need to set the standard and show your team that it's taken seriously and that they need to help.

So, slips and trips happen for a variety of different reasons, but it always comes down to housekeeping really. So walkways need to be clear of items. If there's a box full of wires that's left trailing out over a floor, there shouldn't be. If you see that you need to deal with it yourself or report it to somebody who's going to deal with it and stand by it until it has been fixed. What you should not do is hop over it and then the next person that comes along might not be so observant and might fall over and hurt themselves.

So it's your teams making sure their work environment is well kept. But it's also in terms of things like cleaning, the classic wet floor and making sure that there are signs which are followed around not slipping over.

It's also working from height and the dangers that ladders might present. I would strongly recommend as a project manager, just don't ask any of your team to ever climb up a ladder. It is not worth the hassle. Not unless you work in an industry where it is fully expected and the people involved have been fully trained in working at height.

One more to add, which is sort of a regulation, but it is certainly an internal rule that a lot of organisations will adopt, particularly those that do any kind of manufacturing, and that's 5S.
5S is all about lean manufacturing. It's all about keeping things neat and tidy so that you can make things as efficient as possible. And if it gets into a more manufacturing scenario, it's also about decreasing dangerous instances of things getting stuck in machines or ending up in products where they're not supposed to be.

I had a running battle with the person in charge of 5S back when I was in industry and I think it's worth bringing up because it's something you might experience too. They 5S-ed the factory and the shop floor, which is great. You need to know where your spanner is by putting your spanner on a shadow board so it's always in the same place. You need to know where everything is to make things as efficient as possible. You don't however need to do that in a project team, all sitting at desks.
I kid you not, we had people come round trying to tell us that we needed to have little sections on our desk where there was a space where we put our pen, our ruler, everything else. And then whenever we needed a pen, we always knew that we could just reach out and grab it and that would save us time and make us more efficient.

I struggled with that as a concept and I think they struggled with me trying to tell them to get lost. You don't need to have a 5S policy within an office environment for a project team. Project teams cannot have a complete chaos state of mess where they are working, although now that we're working from home a lot more often perhaps everybody is literally sat in their spare room surrounded by junk. But you don't need to worry about that kind of efficiency.

If you remember going back to the social systems perspective from a few lessons ago, that's a very mechanistic approach to thinking about work and projects, wanting to make it more efficient. Our job as project managers is to make it effective not necessarily efficient.

TRANSCRIPT

Title	Lesson 10 - Micro Lecture 1
Module	Developing People, Leadership and Capabilities
Topic	Responsible Project Management
Narrator	Paul Moses
Date	09/05/22

Content

Responsible Project Management is a movement. It started with some academics at a few UK universities who released a publication and it has been signed up to by a few organisations so far, particularly more public sector organisations. It's something which I believe though is gathering speed and pace with more and more people finding out about it and signing up to it. It's a little bit like how in agile the manifesto started and ten years after a lot of people had picked it up and started to subscribe and use what the manifesto said. And after 20 years it had become a module in its own right in project management degrees. Let's have a look at responsible project management and what it actually says.

So here is the manifesto for responsible project management. It's a call for project professionals to expand their roles by advocating for beneficial change. And the manifesto tries to help facilitate conversations that value three things

- Conscious awareness over ignorance of project impacts
- Regenerative and circular approaches over consumption, damage and waste
- Collaboration and engagement over competition and control

They go on to say that while they recognise that projects, programmes and portfolios need to deliver outputs, outcomes and benefits, unless we all look after the natural world and human communities, projects will contribute to the destruction of humanity. The signatories of the manifesto are developing and applying ways of managing projects that deliver social, environmental and economic value without preference.

When I've engaged with the responsible project management movement, and I've attended some workshops on it, they are very conscious to describe how they are not trying to say that projects need to place everything else above outputs, outcomes and benefits. They fully admit that projects still have to deliver things to quality, on time, to schedule. But they are trying to get to the point where project managers and the teams within projects think about their impact to the environment and to other people as well. It's not just about being green and environmentally friendly.

It's described as a mindset. And when you look at this diagram and think about it from the responsible project management guidance, there's only really one quadrant of this diagram that you'd really want to be in. You wouldn't want to be reckless or malicious in terms of either not caring about the environment and doing things anyway that hurt it, or not understanding your actions. You also wouldn't really want to be in the blissful ignorance category, where perhaps you're not making too much damage but you're also unaware of what it is that you're causing. Conscious awareness is what responsible project management is trying to engender. Being aware of what damage or potential damage you might be doing to people, communities or the environment and therefore trying to minimise what you do, or ideally eradicate what you would do.

And then just like other popular project management manifestos, it's when you get to the principles that you really get to the meat of what it's trying to tell you. So within responsible PM there are 10 driving principles, some of them are more obviously about being responsible than others.

The first is purpose, which arguably is something that you would be doing as a project manager regardless of whether you were signing up to responsible project management or not. So identifying and understanding the purposes underpinning the project. Why you're doing your project and who is it impacting?

Raising awareness of the possible impacts and consequences of your project. Arguably, that is stakeholder management, but responsible PM would say that you need to look at what the positive impacts and consequences are and champion them and look at the negative ones as well and try and stop them from happening. And on some projects maybe that's not even possible to do.

Engagement. So engage with a wide range of stakeholders and promote common interests. Again, something that I would say a PM in general would just do.

Curiosity, be curious to uncover and address ethical complexity, conflict and unintended outcomes. I think that all project managers and the teams that work for them should try and promote curiosity to solve problems in new and innovative ways. It helps with business positioning, if nothing else. This principle is more about ethical complexity than just general problem solving, and I still think that being a curious PM, you will try and address some of those ethics because it will impact upon your stakeholders if nothing else.

Number 5, uncertainty. Recognise uncertainties and encourage clarity and sharing of new knowledge. Again, something that a PM probably just as anyway, regardless of responsible-ness or not.

Anticipation. Anticipate changes, evaluate options and promote informed decision making. Again, something I think you would just do anyway.

Creativity, quite similar to curiosity in my mind if I'm honest. But understands the need for creativity and innovation, make space for imagination within your team. I think that's good advice as a principle anyway.

Transparency. Foster transparency and sharing of visions, thoughts and feelings amongst stakeholders. I think that that's something that responsible project management does stray from perhaps the main path for. If you think back to what we've told you about stakeholder management in the past and your own thoughts and readings upon it, then there are certain stakeholders that you are not being as transparent with as others perhaps. It's not outright lying by any means, but there are certain things that you would go into a lot of detail with some stakeholders and not others. Responsible PM would say to do the opposite, you would want to be transparent and share your visions, thoughts and feelings amongst everybody.

Stewardship. Something more unique to responsible PM. So encourage stewardship of human and environmental resources and ethical considerations. That’s being sustainable. And remember, sustainability is not just about being green for the environment, it's about sustainable relationships with other people, the people on your team and your customers and your stakeholders.

And number 10, balance. Seek balance between the needs of people, planet and profit, short, medium and long term. That is something which I think goes slightly beyond project management into just general business management if I am honest. And that will very much come down to the particular values of a particular organisation. There are organisations that almost certainly will prioritise profit over planet. And there will be other organisations that try and seek a nice balance. Responsible project management would say you're trying to hit that balance. And it would go slightly further in that into trying to suggest that as a project management and a responsible project manager and person you would only want to work for organisations that have that kind of balance.

There's more literature available and one of the more useful parts is perhaps this table, which is the difference between what a typical project manager would do and what a responsible project manager would do. And as you can see from it, really it's a lot about stakeholder management and facilitating relationships and decisions. I think it's perhaps unfair to say that a typical project manager doesn't do all of those things anyway, if I'm honest. However, there is the responsible angle where you are making sure that the ethics and sustainability and environmental protections are brought perhaps more to forefront in your conversations.

There's also two process diagrams, and I'm not sure how helpful these really are in selling the concept to be honest, but they're worth just mentioning. So the first is a five stage model for managing projects responsibly, and it's called LEMON (probably a bad name, I don't think selling lemons to anybody is a good idea). It's listen, engage, measure, organise, next steps. I don't think there's anything revolutionary about that as a five step model for project management. And I'm not sure that it promotes or doesn't promote responsiveness, particularly. But it's another model which is perfectly valid if not popular.

The other one is the eco-cycle for responsible project management. And I can see why a graphic designer would have designed a particular diagram to look like this for something to do with the environment. However, this is worth just touching upon because it goes around in an infinite loop, going round actions and advocacy. Advocacy is certainly a word that isn't used that much within the project management terminology. But trying to advocate for your stakeholders, so engaging them, understanding their concerns, using your empathy to try and understand where they're coming from and trying to advocate for them, is something that's a bit unique to responsible project management, and is perhaps not as silly an idea as it first appears.

Regardless of how much you like or buy-in to responsible project management, I think that this table that they've produced is genuinely quite useful regardless. Asking yourselves these questions at the beginning of a project is probably quite good practise. And it's not all to do with responsible-ness either.

So understanding who you are responsible to, who is your sponsor, perfectly reasonable.

What are you responsible for? Again, having that clear definition between responsibilities of sponsor and yourself as a PM.

When unanticipated things happen, what do we do? In my mind, that is risk management. Absolutely something you should be considering up front.

What types of conversations do we have within the project team? You can argue that that's an internal communication strategy, but I think it's something a little bit less formal than that. Actually it's more to do with making sure that there are more social conversations going on within the team as well. Which going back to our motivations theory and how teams come together, it’ss quite important to get teams to trust each other on a more personal level.

Which individuals or organisations are important? For me, that's stakeholder management, and it's prioritising different stakeholders. I realise responsible project management then says you should be transparent with all of them, but even if you were going to do that, you would still need to prioritise and decide who is most important. Who has power, influence?

What does your team care about? That's a newer question and I don't think that's something you'd have necessarily asked yourself without responsible project management in your mind. But knowing what your team does care about, what drives them, what motivates them, why they're on the project? Possibly because of a boss told me to go join the team, but why are they at the company? Is it because they're there to make a difference with what the organisation does? Or is it because they want to collect a salary and don't really care if they're doing good or bad in the world or not.

What are your projects, outputs and outcomes? Standard project management.

And what types of conversations do we have outside the team? So that's the types of conversations that you have with stakeholders. An external communications strategy or plan.

As you can see, going through the eight of those, I'm not sure that any truly unique new questions that you wouldn't necessarily have asked yourself anyway without knowing about responsible project management. But I do think as a set of eight questions to ask at the beginning, it's quite helpful.

And then finally that document goes onto another set of questions to ask yourself relating back to the 10 principles behind responsible project management. In a second after this lecture I'll ask you to go and have a look at the documentation, there's a page or so on each of those principles for you to really try and get your head around all of them. Some of them I think are more interesting or more practical than others, but they all have a place and it's well worth understanding and reading them and asking yourself how you're trying to meet each of those principles perhaps.

I'll let you be the judge as to whether you think responsible PM is a lot of wishy washy nice ideas which would be nice but aren't very practical. Or whether it's something which you can actually use and have a mindset of and live your project management life by.

Regardless of that, it is something that is being picked up by more and more. Whether they're just signing it because it's a nice thing to say they do, or whether they truly believe in it. In the same way at an individual level, you can have the booklet of responsible project management and you can put it pride of place in front of your desk. Or have a badge that says that that's what you do on the end of your email signatures. But it's very different from just having it out there for people to look at and go, “oh you're responsible” versus having it be part of your mindset as to how you actually manage projects. Is it just a badge, or is it something more, like a mindset?

GUIDE to the COMPLETION of A PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN

What is a Personal Development Plan?

The aim of creating a **personal development plan** is to document a process of self-analysis, personal reflection and honest appraisal of your strengths and weaknesses. This should enable you to evaluate the value of the leadership and management training you have received, and to consider your future leadership development.

What do I need to do?

An example of a PDP included later in this GUIDE, and should be read in conjunction with the requirements outlined below. This task is relatively short, succinct and designed to be helpful in evaluating your leadership development. It enables you to reflect upon your recent experience and to focus on the next stage of your training and development. Creating your PDP has three stages as follows:

a. **Stage 1 – Personal Analysis.** The first stage is designed to analyse your strengths and weaknesses. You will be able to draw heavily upon your career and the outcomes of courses that you may have attended. These should be supplemented by the perceived opportunities that will have been derived from your experience and any threats to your continued success.

b. **Stage 2 – Setting Goals.** This involves setting new and clearly definable goals for yourself which are measurable. The example PDP provides clear guidance on identifying these. You will need to consult your immediate superior (your first reporting officer/line manager)

c. **Stage 3 – Personal Objectives.** This stage involves setting out your personal objectives. These can also be set in context within your civilian employment as shown in the example, which will be helpful in reinforcing its value.

Example of a Personal Development Plan

Mr A is a 25 year old graduate working for a well-known mobile telecommunications company. He is 2 years into their graduate recruitment programme. He joined the organisation while at university and transferred to his current department following graduation. After a year he was encouraged to enter a managerial leadership and management development programme. He re-joined his department as a junior manager.

His employer is supportive and has been reasonably flexible and supportive in making allowances for the additional time off work to complete all the training modules.

Once properly qualified and with more experience, he is keen to take on more responsibility and be seconded to another part of the company.

The example PDP is set out over the following page

PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN (EXAMPLE)

Name: Mr A **Department:** **Organisation:**

Date Personal Development Plan Completed:

Part 1 – Personal Analysis

Before setting your short medium and long term personal development plans, you should conduct a personal analysis: Eg - What are my strengths and weaknesses? What external opportunities or threats might affect any plans I might make?

Strengths	Areas for further development
My personal administration in the company and basic skills are good and my detailed knowledge is generally sound for my level of training. I gained confidence from proving that I could cope with the pressures of the L and M course, even with sleep depravation. I was assessed to be composed during practical work and provided clear direction. Having the opportunity to lead a team over an extended period of time, I demonstrated that I have the ability to provide clear direction and manage people to achieve specific tasks whilst under pressure.	It was difficult to maintain the work/life balance and maintain my physical fitness standards during academic studies. As a result I have lost some physical fitness. I need to take more time in planning a task thoroughly before briefing my subordinates. Ie provide the solution not present the problem. My understanding of the estimate planning process is still superficial in places and requires more detail. In order to build my confidence in command I need more experience of team management in different scenarios
Opportunities	**Threats**
Demonstrate to my employer that I have had both structured management and leadership training and	Balance work and personal commitments.

experience of leading teams to achieve specific tasks. Also to highlight that I have been exposed to a more structured approach to analysing problems which will assist me in providing clear solutions will be of value to the quality of my work for the company I work for. *This activity provides a space for renewal in a hectic business environment to achieve a better work life balance allowing me to be refreshed and more focused at work.* *I can call on the support of my line manager to give me guidance on personal development.* *The company formal annual appraisal process will provide a source of guaranteed feedback.*	

Part 2 – Setting Goals

What do I want to learn?	What do I have to do?	What support and resources will I need?	How will I measure success?	Target date for review?
Greater depth of knowledge of leading in the business external activities	Complete M and L Course (4 weekends) Training and the company Young Managers (YM) development programme	1. Regional Training Centre and YM Course Directing Staff. 2. Finding 2 weeks for the YM could be difficult.	1. Courses Assessment. 2. YM Course Assessment report. 3. Line managers Appraisal Report (LMAP) including mid-year appraisal will assess performance and potential.	Post 31 Mar report
	Get to know my department team and build their confidence and trust in me.	Advice from my Line Manager and team feedback	1. Formal and informal appraisal. 2. Self-appraisal.	Post 31 Mar report
	Identify key training opportunities in the Business Forecast of Events and de-conflict with work and social life. Because of YMs course I may not be able to engage in all business activities	I will need to discuss and agree my priorities with my Line Manager.	1. Prioritisation of goals forms part of my appraisal process. 2. Ensure that I have attended all the agreed high priority training.	Post 31 Mar report
Widen my understanding of leadership.	Learn from the more by observing experienced managers. Gain their friendship and trust.	Senior colleagues.	Mentoring and performance appraisal. During development programmes.	Post 31 Mar report
Improve my personal fitness.	Allocate specific evenings during the week for fitness training and allocate time at	Advice from Gym Fitness Instr	Improved fitness levels will be self-evident. Improved Personal Fitness	Quarterly Bi-

	weekends. Develop personal fitness programme to improve fitness and stamina.		Test score.	annually Annual
Achieve core business skills.	Complete mandatory organisation update training i.e. CPD		Secure bonus benefits as appropriate	31 Mar annually
Build confidence in as a leader/ management.	Volunteer to lead ad-hoc cross functional projects to build credibility and experience as a leader	Line manager	Feedback from the team and the project sponsor.	End of the project
Improve planning/ decision-making skills.	Gain further experience of business analysis processes. Use this in a working environment to speed up and improve complex decision making	Use training opportunities and revision.	Good YMs course report.	

Part 3 – Personal Objectives

Short Term Goals (next 12 months)
Complete Young Managers Course in order to become eligible for engagement in complex business project activities. *(I accept that some of these goals may slip into year 2 but no further).* *Have accountability for a significant cross-functional project at work.*
Medium Term Goals (next 2 – 3 years)
Be given responsibility for leading and managing a small team of in support of a challenging business project. *Engage in supporting some functions of a cross-functional project team which gives me significant business exposure.*
Longer Term Goals (beyond 3 years)
Gain promotion to middle management and gain a support of work colleagues and senior managers. *Be given responsibility for managing a large team of direct reports/ a number of teams (Work towards becoming a Head of Department).*